

MCM301 Short Notes final term

Lec 19 to 45

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Lesson 19 Making a Good Speech

Making a Good Speech

Making a good speech involves careful preparation and effective delivery. Here are some tips to help you deliver a compelling and engaging speech:

- **Understand your audience:** Tailor your speech to suit the interests, needs, and knowledge level of your audience. Consider their demographics and background to ensure your message resonates with them.
- **Define your objective:** Clearly articulate the purpose of your speech. Whether it's to inform, persuade, entertain, or inspire, having a clear objective will help you structure your speech effectively.
- **Organize your content:** Create a logical flow for your speech by organizing your key points and supporting details in a coherent manner. Use an introduction to grab attention, body paragraphs to present your main ideas, and a conclusion to summarize key points and leave a lasting impression.
- **Use storytelling and examples:** Engage your audience by incorporating relevant stories, anecdotes, and examples. This will make your speech more relatable and memorable.
- **Connect with your audience:** Establish a connection with your audience by using eye contact, gestures, and vocal variety. Make them feel involved by asking rhetorical questions or encouraging audience participation.
- **Use visual aids sparingly:** Visual aids like slides or props can enhance your speech, but avoid overusing them. They should support your message, not distract from it. Keep them simple and easy to understand.
- **Practice, practice, practice:** Rehearse your speech multiple times before the actual presentation. This will help you become familiar with your content and improve your delivery. Time yourself to ensure you stay within the allotted time.
- **Maintain a confident posture:** Stand tall, maintain good posture, and use confident body language throughout your speech. This will convey authority and capture the attention of your audience.
- **Use vocal techniques:** Modulate your voice, vary your tone, and pace your speech appropriately. This will add emphasis and keep your audience engaged throughout.
- **End with a strong closing:** Craft a memorable closing statement that summarizes your main points and leaves a lasting impression. Consider using a call to action or a thought-provoking question to encourage further reflection or action.

Overcoming stage fright

Everyone experiences stage fright, speech anxiety, or fear of the audience. Surveys show that fear of speaking in front of people is one of the greatest fears people have. The following lists some techniques people use for coping with this freight:

- **Know the room:** Be familiar with where you will speak. Arrive early, walk around the speaking area and practice using the microphone and any visual aids.
- **Know the audience:** Greet some of them as they arrive. It's easier to speak to a group of friends than to a group of strangers.
- **Know your material:** If you're not familiar or are uncomfortable with it, your nervousness will increase. Practice your speech and revise it if necessary.
- **Relax:** Ease tension by doing exercises.
- **Visualize yourself giving your speech:** Imagine yourself speaking, your voice loud, clear, and assured. When you visualize yourself as successful, you will be successful.
- **Realize that people want you to succeed:** Audiences want you to be interesting, stimulating, Informative, and entertaining. They don't want you to fail.
- **Don't apologize:** If you mention your nervousness or apologize for any problems you think you have with your speech, you may be calling the audience's attention to something they hadn't noticed.
- **Turn nervousness into positive energy:** Harness your nervous energy and transform it into vitality and enthusiasm.
- **Gain experience:** Experience builds confidence, which is the key to effective speaking.

Types of Speech

Informative Speech

An **informative speech** is a **type** of presentation that aims to educate or provide information to the audience about a specific topic. The primary goal of an informative speech is to impart knowledge, explain concepts, **or clarify complex subjects in a clear and organized manner**. Unlike persuasive speeches, which seek to convince the audience to adopt a particular viewpoint or take a specific action, **informative speeches focus on delivering factual information**.

Types of informative speeches:

Objects, processes, events, concepts

Objects:

These speeches provide information about tangible items, such as products, artifacts, or physical objects.

Processes:

This type of speech explains a sequence of steps or stages involved in a particular activity or process.

Events:

Informative speeches about events involve providing details about occurrences, incidents, or happenings.

Concepts:

These speeches focus on abstract ideas, theories, or philosophies, aiming to clarify and explain them to the audience.

Persuasive speech

A persuasive speech is a type of speech where the goal is to convince the audience to accept the speaker's point of view or perform a desired action. The speaker uses words and visuals to guide the audience's thoughts and actions.

Kinds of persuasive speeches

Question of Fact

A question about the truth or falsity of an assertion

Question of Value

A question about the worth, rightness, morality, and so forth of an idea or action

Question of Policy

A question about whether a specific course of action should or should not be taken

Organizing persuasive speeches

- **Problem-Solution:** first, show the existence of a problem, then present a solution
- **Problem-Cause-Solution:** identify the problem; analyze the causes of the problem; present a solution
- **Comparative Advantages:** each main point explains why a speaker's solution to a problem is preferable to other proposed solutions (used when the audience agrees a problem exists)
- **Motivated Sequence:** good for speeches that seek immediate action

Principles of persuasion

While preparing persuasive speeches, keep in mind that people are more likely to change their behavior if the proposition asks for a small change rather than a large change in their lives (e.g., trying one vegetarian meal rather than becoming total vegetarians).

Lesson 20 Handling Questions & Answers

Handling Questions & Answers

Business presentations commonly include verbal feedbacks from the audience. This refers to questions, comments, or objections that are voiced by persons in the audience. A presenter can prepare effective responses by following the four steps as below:

1. Anticipating
2. Answering
3. Revising
4. Rehearsing

Anticipating

Questions and comments that an audience is likely to raise can be anticipated by considering:

- Previous experience
- Common concerns
- Planning
- Input from associates

Previous Experience

If a presenter has delivered the same or a similar subject previously, it is helpful to recall the questions or objections that were raised before.

Common Concerns

A presenter should expect questions or objections on issues that commonly interest or concern people. In broad terms, such issues pertain to time, cost, and impact.

Planning

Planning for a presentation can reveal questions and concerns that may be raised. These questions guide the planning process and help a presenter gain insight into the audience. By asking questions, a presenter can identify questions an audience may ask.

Input from Associates

Business associates can be a helpful source for identifying probable questions and objections. Associates who have more experience than the presenter in certain areas (the subject, the audience or a role the speaker has recently acquired) can serve as "advisors," alerting the presenter to the type of audience feedback to expect.

Answering

Write out answers to anticipated questions and objections. Anticipating audience feedback does not fully prepare a presenter to respond skillfully. A presenter must determine how each question or comment will be answered. It is useful to prepare two options: summary answer and an expanded explanation. In most cases, it is preferable to answer in a summary manner (especially when time is limited). However, if summary answer does not satisfy the person who raised the issue, the presenter is prepared with a more detailed "back-up" answer.

Revising

Revise the content of the presentation. After anticipating questions and preparing answers to them, a presenter may find it advantageous to revise the content of the message.

"How, you might ask, would you implement this program?

That's the next point we'll consider." "What impact can you expect?

Understandably, many of our clients have asked that same question. They found..." When anticipated questions or objections are addressed as part of the content of a message, the presenter is relieved of the pressure of having to formulate an answer on the spot.

Rehearsing

Rehearse a Q & A session:

Q & A is an abbreviation for the question-and-answer period that accompanies many presentations. Unless a presenter is proficient in fielding questions, and the presentation is one that has been done before, the presenter should rehearse a Q&A.

Inviting Questions & Comments Types of verbal feedback to anticipate.

When it serves the purpose of a presentation to encourage audience involvement at the outset, a speaker can elicit questions or comments before delivering the body of the message. Audience feedback can, in fact, serve as the opener to a presentation.

Questions and comments during a presentation

Typically, a presenter would not invite questions from the audience during a 15-minute speech at a service club luncheon. It might be appropriate and useful to do so during a one-hour sales demonstration. It is highly recommended to actively engage the audience during a full-day seminar or a three-day training session.

When done during a presentation, the best time to ask for questions or comments is after each key point. In that way, the presenter and the audience are less likely to lose the "train of thought" Before resuming the presentation, the speaker would make a transition statement: a brief summary (of the previous point) and preview (of the next point) that helps to bring the audience back on track with the subject.

Q & A at the end of a presentation

In more structured setting, with larger audiences, or with a limited time frame, it is customary to defer audience comments and questions until the end of a presentation. If a Q & A session is promised, it is imperative to finish the presentation early enough to allow sufficient time for questions. After inviting questions from the audience, a presenter should pause at least 30 seconds. In this way, audience attention can be refocused on the speaker and the subject, and the speaker can control the manner in which the presentation ends.

Lesson 21 Responding Questions & Answers

The following four steps are essential to an effective response. In the first two, a presenter is in the role of "receiver." In the third and fourth, the presenter resumes the "sender" role.

1. Listen
2. Distinguish
3. Affirm
4. Answer

Listen attentively

For a presenter to be effective, speaking skills are important. Listening skills are equally important. By listening attentively, a presenter signals interest in the audience and in what other people have to say. In addition, listening (or failing to listen) affects how a presenter responds to verbal feedback. When someone from the audience speaks, and the presenter is listening attentively, the presenter should:

- Make focused meaningful eye contact with the person who is talking.
- Nod gently in a manner that suggests, "Yes, I hear you."
- Lean forward (slightly) to visually convey interest.
- Match facial expression to the nature of the question or objection. In some cases, a gracious smile is appropriate; in other cases an expression of genuine concern.
- Listen for the meaning in the message. To extract the main point of a question or objection, concentrate on key words. Conjunctions (and, or, but) and modifying words (descriptive adjectives and adverbs) are extraneous to the real meaning.
- Listen to determine if the person communicates in a concrete or conceptual manner. Typically, concrete thinkers communicate in shorter sentences and use words like "bottom-line." (They prefer a succinct, "Bottom-line" response based on facts.) Conceptual thinkers tend to be more expressive and use words like "possibilities." (They prefer a more comprehensive response that conveys ideas.)

Discern the nature and intent of verbal feedback

Discernment is related to perception. A presenter perceives things about people in an audience in the same way an audience perceives things about a presenter.

Affirm the person

A skillful response consists of two parts; affirmation and answer. An affirmation is a relational technique that acknowledges and validates people. Even when a question or objection challenges a speaker, it is essential to maintain an affirmative relationship with the audience.

Answer the question, comment, or objection

The characteristics of effective communication apply to answering audience feedback. In other words, a presenter's response should be clear, correct, concise, and well considered.

Clear

A clear response is "on point." The audience clearly understands the answer because it pertains specifically to the question raised.

Example:-

- A person in the audience is confused and asks a question. Usually, such questions are answered when the presenter states the point that was omitted.
- A question arises because the person was not listening attentively during the presentation. Such questions can be satisfied by summarizing the point the person missed.
- A message delivered predominately in concrete terms may prompt questions from people who think conceptually, and vice versa. In this case, a point may be clarified by drawing a comparison to something with which the audience would be familiar, by restating the point in another way, or by illustrating the point with a visual aid.

Correct

Answers should be both factually and ethically correct. A factually correct answer is not only accurate; it is complete as well.

Concise

A concise answer is "to the point." Some presenters are pontificators; they respond to every question in great detail and at great length. They subject the audience to a 20-minute exposition on the technological development of audiovisual equipment.

Types of comments from an audience

When a member of the audience comments on some point of a presenter the comment will express one of the following:

- Agreement
- Addition
- Objection

Comments of agreement

A comment of agreement expresses concurrence with a point made during a presentation. Such comments characteristically reflect a desire to be heard or an interest in having the presenter's proposal adopted. The appropriate response to a comment of agreement is to say, simply, "Thank you."

Comments of addition

A comment of addition also implies agreement, but adds to what the presenter has said.

- The appropriate reply to a comment of addition is to offer a brief acknowledgment such as, "Thank you. That's a very good point" or "I appreciate your bringing that up."

Objections

The term objection is commonly understood to mean disagreement or disapproval. Comments that sound like objections may, in fact, express a genuine interest in seeking further information or clarification.

The key to ridding objections skillfully is to refrain from taking objections personally. Objections must be handled with composure and tact. The objective is to dissipate the issue, not to dispute the other person's point of view.

There are three appropriate responses to an objection:

- Agree
- Re-approach
- Arbitrate

Agree

Agree is a collaborative decision-making platform that helps teams make faster, more transparent decisions. It allows users to gather feedback, discuss ideas, and vote on proposals in a structured and organized manner. "Thank you for bringing that to our attention".

Re-approach

In mass communication refers to the process of revisiting a communication strategy or message in order to improve its effectiveness. This could involve re-evaluating the target audience, adjusting the tone or content of the message, or finding new channels for distribution. "However, let's consider this from another angle."

Arbitrate

Objections can be resolved with the use of a "feel-felt-found" response. The presenter states, "I can understand why you would feel that way."

The Appropriate Response to Disruptions

Skilled presenters do so with aplomb, which is best described as "grace under pressure." With confidence and poise they remain in control of the presentation event by following the three steps listed below.

- Remain calm
- Take action
- Be flexible

Disruptive incidents

Three tactics can be employed for dealing with disruptive incidents: detour, delay, or dismiss.

- Detour
- Delay
- Dismiss

Diversion/ Detour

A detour is a way around a disruption that enables a presenter to still reach the objective of a presentation.

Delay

Out of respect for the audience, a presentation should always start on time. However, it may not proceed as planned.

Dismiss

Although they rarely occur, some disruptions are best handled by dismissing the audience. Acts of nature such as fire and earthquakes are reasons to dismiss an audience, as are some medical emergencies.

Disruptive behavior

Disruptive behavior signals intent not to hear but to be heard. The disruptive person speaks out at every opportunity. Persons who behave in such a manner are "detractors." A detractor is someone whose behavior detracts from the quality of a presentation, from the attentiveness of other members of the audience, and from what the presenter is trying to accomplish.

Common reasons for disruptive behavior are:

- Resistance to change
- Resentment of the presenter
- Repetition of behavior that is successful for the detractor

Resistance to change

Frequently, a presentation delivers information and ideas that challenge customary ways of thinking or of doing things. Some people are not receptive to anything new. They feel threatened by new ideas, new information, new systems, new procedures, and new policies.

Resentment

During the course of presentation, an effective speaker fills a leadership role: leading the audience through material and managing the people in the group. An accomplished speaker exhibits enthusiastic

attributes: organization and communication skills, energy and enthusiasm, presence and personal power.

Repeating successful behavior

People are inclined to repeat behavior that has worked for them in the past. When they get what they want by acting in a certain manner, they will act that way again to get what they want what a disruptive person wants is what every person wants: attention.

Dealing with disruptive behavior

With an awareness of the reasons that underlie disruptive behavior, a presenter can more easily deal with it with aplomb by practicing these techniques:

- Be courteous
- Exercise control
- Confront

Be courteous

Detractors try to provoke presenters. If a presenter reacts to disruptive behavior with frustration, aggravation, or impatience, the detractor has "won" and will likely continue to disrupt the presentation.

Exercise control

When a courteous response does not suffice to quell disruptive behavior, a presenter must next exert control over the situation. Maintaining control is one of the responsibilities of presenting.

Confront

When a person persists in being disruptive, a presenter must confront the behavior. The experience of the many in the audience takes precedence over one or two detractors. If the situation allows, it is helpful to announce a brief refreshment break or to direct the group to engage in an activity (such as a work book exercise or discussion with persons seated nearby).

Lesson 22 Significance of the Setting

Psychological

Physical factors influence the audience frame of mind. People think, feel and respond much differently in a room that is light, spacious, cool, quiet, and fresh than in one that is dark, crowded, stuffy, noisy, or musty. An unpleasant physical environment is detrimental to the psychological environment.

Perceptual

A meeting room conveys a "message." A presenter communicates through vocal and visual cues, from which an audience forms perceptions. In a similar manner, every room contains visible and audible components, which likewise shape audience perceptions.

Speaker concentration

A setting may contain elements that disrupt a speaker's ability to concentrate. In distracting or disruptive situations, it is doubly difficult to conduct a productive presentation and bring about a successful outcome.

Complementary characteristics

A setting should be selected on the basis of what will complement the presentation. A setting is most effective when it is comfortable for the audience, well suited to the intent of the presentation event, and serves the needs of the presenter in relation to the audience.

Comfortable for the audience

A primary factor to consider when deciding on the setting for a presentation is how to create the greatest degree of comfort for the audience. Presentations commonly introduce something new: a new produce, service, supplier, a new policy, new information, or a new approach.

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Seating considerations and room arrangements

When the presenter has the option to select the site and direct the set-up of the room, primary consideration should be given to audience seating.

- Audience Size(extra seating should be available)
- Audience Composition (proportion of various types of people, classified by demographic or psychographic characteristics, reached by an advertising medium or message)
- Workspace (A workspace is your board for each of the brands or clients you are working with. So, everything is organized in a much better way.)
- Interaction (Will members of the group be asked to interact with one another)
- Duration (how long something lasts, from beginning to end.)
- Tables (If space permits, it is preferable to place a head table lengthwise (perpendicular to the audience) to reduce the barrier between presenter and audience. Doing so also allows greater freedom of movement for the presenter).

- Aisles (Between seating, aisles need to be created to provide for a safe and smooth flow of traffic in and out of a room. Access for persons with disabilities must be considered as well.)
- Visibility (Seating should be arranged in such a manner that the presenter will be clearly visible to everyone in the audience. Every seat should also afford a clear view of visual aids. The visibility factor must be taken into account when selecting a facility for a presentation to a large audience.)
- Open Space (If the time frame is such that a presentation includes a break period(s). Consideration should be given to the area where people will gather during the break.)

Types of seating arrangements

As the diagrams that follow illustrate, audience seating can be arranged in a number of different ways.

- **Conventional theater style**

With a theater-style arrangement, people in the audience are seated in rows and columns without tables. Theater-style seating is most common with Proactive presentation delivered to large audiences seating may also be arranged in this manner for a presentation to a smaller group that must meet in a room with limited space.

- **Theatre Style**

Theater-style seating is the least comfortable for an audience, especially for presentations that last longer than an hour. Many people feel constrained when seated shoulder-to-shoulder in closely packed rows. If the audience is seated in movable chairs and if space permits, the presenter may want to invite people to move their chairs back, to the sides, or farther toward the front to gain more 'elbow room' (provided a center aisle is kept open for exiting the room).

- **SEMI-CIRCLE**

Each audience member can see everyone's face in the row. Audience is more comfortable to see the presenter standing. Many people will laugh just because they see others laughing.

- **conventional classroom style**

A conventional classroom style is so called because it first appeared in instructional settings where the primary intent is learning. People in the audience are seated at tables, which are arranged in columns and rows. The classroom style is used for presentations in both Proactive and Interactive modes.

- **Classroom Style T-formation**

Similar to seating at a conference table, the T-formation is suitable for presentations to smaller groups. People seated at the table(s) can alternately direct their attention toward the presenter or for purposes of discussion; they can turn to others seated nearby.

- **Modified T-formation**

This seating arrangement is an adaptation of the conventional classroom style. It is useful for Interactive presentation to smaller groups, especially those that involve breaking out into pairs or groups of four for activities.

- **U-formation**

The U-formation is suitable for both promotional and informational presentations in either the Proactive or Interactive modes. It is one arrangement that allows every person in the audience to view not only the presenter, but every other person in the audience as well.

- **Boardroom**

It facilitates good interaction among the participants and is often used for decision-making purposes. Seating around an oblong table everyone can see everyone and can easily share images and texts which are spread across the table.

- **V-formation**

This arrangement is a modification of conventional classroom seating. To seat the same number of people in a V-formation as would be seated in classroom style requires a wider room.

- **Lighting**

Lighting affects the mood in a meeting room. Dim lighting or dark rooms produce a dreary, somber mood. Lighting that approximates natural daylight (on a sunny day) creates a livelier, happy mood.

- **Temperature**

When choosing a facility, it is important to check if meeting rooms are individually climate-controlled. The temperature should be cool (68 to 70 degrees), but not cold or chilly. An audience will remain more alert in a cooler room. People become uncomfortable in a room that is too cold or too hot. For presentations to larger groups, prior to the presentation the thermostat should be set lower than normal.

- **Air quality**

To prevent a room from becoming stuffy, the meeting room should be well ventilated. When considering prospective sites for a presentation, a presenter should be alert to unpleasant odors. Older facilities, for instance may smell musty.

- **Sound**

In a presentation setting, the only sound that should be prominent is that of the speaker's voice (or members of the audience when they voice feedback). Unfortunately, extraneous sounds can fill a meeting room and disrupt a presentation.

Audiences expect you to use visual aids in your oral presentations. Visual aids can improve the quality and impact of your oral presentation by:

- creating the attention of your listeners,
- illustrating points that are difficult to explain in words alone,
- enhancing understanding of the topic,
- centering the attention of the listeners,
- adding variety,
- helping your speech have lasting impact,
- emphasizing your information & ideas, and
- Helping your listeners remember your talk.

To find the right media for your presentation you need to first determine:

- The size of your audience.
- Whether or not there will be audience participation.
- The room size, arrangement, lighting, acoustics, climate and safety of your presentation environment.
- The presentation budget.
- Equipment and supply limitations.
- Time constraints.

Computer based Presentation

The availability of affordable software and new technology has made computer based presentations the visual aid of choice in most business situations. What used to take weeks of preparation and an outside production house can now be created by you at your desktop.

Benefits

- Dynamic, full-color multimedia presentations are available to the average presenter
- Data can be presented in real time
- Supply costs are non-existent
- Last minute changes are possible
- Special effects add interest
- Production costs are low
- Transmission to remote locations is possible

Limitations:

- Projection equipment is expensive
- Computer and graphic skills are required
- Presentation depends more upon equipment than the presenter

- A darkened room is required

Helpful Hints:

- Before your presentation check equipment for proper location and function.
- Use only a high-intensity overhead projector
- Use a remote control device to advance your visuals
- If you do not have a remote, have an assistant advance the visuals
- Back up your computer media and take an extra copy with you
- Unless you take your own computer, use the view or runtime version on your computer software program so you do not have to load your software to the computer
- Use a laser pointer to focus the audience's attention
- If possible, vary the presentation with another activity so that you can turn the lights on.

Video

When you need to show real-life motion in your presentation, video is the most effective medium. Video clips are used with computer graphics to create multimedia presentations. These presentations incorporate text, graphics, animation, and motion video. These cost-effective, plug-and-play projectors allow you to project high-quality video images from VCRs, cameras, laser disc players, and CD players.

Benefits

- Presentations are professional.
- Full-color motion with sound is possible.
- Duplicating presentation is simple.
- Presentations may be more entertaining.
- Presentation does not require presenter.
- Small cassettes are easy to store.
- Presenting to large remote audience is possible.

Limitations:

- Professional production is required.
- Production is expensive and time consuming.
- Little presenter involvement--can be impersonal.
- Discourages audience participation.

Helpful Hints

- Before your presentation, become familiar with and test all equipment.
- Make sure the room can be properly darkened.
- Be sure that you have enough monitors in place for adequate viewing.

- Keep video presentations short (ten minutes is considered the limit for attention and concentration).
- To increase participation, ask your audience to look for a specific idea or activity in the video before viewing it. Then refer to it by asking questions after viewing.

35mm Slides

The content of 35mm slides provides a crisp, colorful, easy to read format for presenting information. 35mm slides are the most universally accepted way to show full-color, three-dimensional still pictures.

Benefits

- Images are the highest quality.
- Presentations can be easily duplicated.
- Projectors are reliable, portable and easy to use.
- Remote control enables the presenter to move around the room.

Limitations:

- Darkened room is required (or uses rear projection system in lit room).
- Discourages audience participation.
- Presenter is more impersonal.
- More preparation time is necessary.
- Note-taking is difficult.
- Previewing and editing is difficult.

Helpful Hints:

- Arrange and place your slides in the slide tray and check to see that they are in the proper order and right side-up before arriving at the presentation.
- Once the slides are positioned in the slide tray, use a marker to draw a line around the top of the entire ring of slides. If your tray spills, you'll quickly distinguish top from bottom on each slide.
- Be sure the lights are properly adjusted.
- Try to keep enough light so that you can maintain some eye contact with the audience.
- Use a laser pointer to focus the audience on a specific point.
- Number the slides in case they do spill.
- Make sure the slides are in focus before you start.
- If you want to discuss a topic without any visuals, use a black slide.
- Face the audience at all times.
- If possible, vary the presentation with another activity so that you can turn the lights on.

Lesson 24 Visual Aids

Overhead Transparencies

Overhead projection is the most versatile and popular presentation medium used by businesses today. Because of its effectiveness and wide acceptance, its popularity is continuing to grow. The projectors are brighter, quieter, and more portable and high-quality transparencies can now be printed in full color directly from your computer.

Benefits

- Presenter has complete control over the presentation.
- Presenter faces the audience in a fully lit room.
- Visuals can easily be rearranged or omitted to fit the needs of the presenter or audience.
- Material can be highlighted or revealed point-by-point.
- Material can be created or added during a presentation using a projectable marker.
- Transparencies are easy and inexpensive to produce.
- An overhead projector is comfortable and simple to use.

Limitations:

- Can be used for groups of up to 100 people.
- Presenter must rely on equipment.
- Older projectors tend to be dim and noisy.
- Presenter is forced to remain near the projector in order to change transparencies.
- Audiences that don't understand the benefits of overhead projection may perceive it as outdated.

Helpful Hints:

- Test to see if the visual is in focus and if the projector is the right distance from the screen before you begin.
- Place the overhead to your RIGHT if you are right handed and to your LEFT if you are left handed-This will make it easier for you to face your audience and write if you need to. In either case, you want to stand in the center of the speaking area.
- Place your overhead projector on a table low enough so it does not block you or the screen. Have a small table next to the overhead so you can stack your overheads before and after you use them.
- To create a smooth transition and keep the audience from staring at a glaring white screen, turn the projector off before placing the next transparency.
- Be sure you have a spare lamp. Nothing is more unsettling than to have your overhead projector bulb goes out during your presentation. Bring spare bulbs and a glove to change the bulb. The old bulb will be HOT! Make sure you know how to change the bulb.

- Don't look at or point to the screen, look at the transparency or maintain eye contact with your audience.
- Use a pencil, pointer, or color highlighting system when pointing to a transparency on the stage of the projector.
- To reveal one line at a time, put a sheet of paper under your transparency and slide it toward you as you discuss each item.
- If you want the attention focused on you and a point you're emphasizing, turn the overhead projector off and move inward the group.
- Make sure what's projected is short and simple.
- Tape the power chord to the floor to protect you or someone else from tripping.
- Mount transparencies in a frame for easy handling.
- Write your name on mounting frames and number them.

Flipcharts

While everyone seems to be interested in creating high-tech computer generated presentations, the flip chart still continues to be the most effective presentation media of all. **One should not assume that investing a lot of money in high tech visual aids & equipment will "make" your presentation.**

Flipcharts are ideal for recording audience input, reinforcing important points, or gathering information obtained during brainstorming sessions. It is an ideal presentation medium for executive offices, small conference rooms, onsite locations, and courtrooms any location where projection equipment is unavailable or doesn't suit the environment.

Benefits:

- Clip charts do not need electricity - You don't need to worry if the bulb will burn out or worry about additional presentation equipment.
- Flip charts are economical - They do not require you to use any special films or printers to produce them.
- Flipcharts can be used in fully-lit rooms, allowing the presenter to be the focus of the presentation
- Handwritten flipcharts are ideal for brainstorming sessions and encourage participation when used to record audience input
- The easel is reliable, predictable, comfortable and readily available
- Flipcharts can be used in a variety of environments that aren't suitable for projection equipment-- outdoors, small rooms and on-site locations
- Flip charts allow spontaneity - Any last minute changes can be easily made.

Limitations:

- Can be used for group of up to 35 people only.

- Presenter must have high energy.
- Handwritten flipcharts require good penmanship and still may be difficult to read.
- Handwritten flipcharts lack professionalism and credibility.
- Preparation of handwritten flipcharts is labor intensive and therefore costly to produce.

Helpful Hints:

- Make sure the flip charts you use will fit the flip chart stand you will be using. Some have different spaced holes at the top.
- When preparing your charts, it is best to first design your charts on paper first before drawing them on the actual flip chart pad.
- Lightly write your text in pencil first before using the actual flip chart markers. This will allow you to make any adjustments with text spacing and any figures you will be drawing. Do NOT use all block letters (UPPER CASE). Using upper and lower case letters makes it easier to read. Use the 7 x 7 rule. Have no more than 7 words on each line and no more than 7 lines to a sheet. Using a 6 x 6 rule is even better.
- Use flip chart markers and not regular magic markers. Flip chart markers will not "bleed" through the paper.
- Avoid using the colors yellow, pink, or orange. These are extremely difficult for the audience to see. Avoid using too many colors.
- You can write "lightly in pencil" any notes next to key points you need. The audience won't be able to see them. You may also write what is on the next sheet. Knowing this will allow you to properly introduce your next sheet.

Whiteboard

The chalkboard is probably the oldest, most familiar visual aid. It has evolved over the years from the standard black or green hard chalk variety to whiteboard that requires the use of liquid markers.

Information can now be written quietly, in brighter colors, and erased completely with considerably less effort.

Benefit

- Whiteboards are ideal for recording spontaneous information.

Limitations:

- Can be used for groups of up to 30 people only.
- Handwritten material may be difficult to read.
- Audience attention may be lost while presenter turns his/her back to write.
- A whiteboard used as a primary presentation medium conveys lack of preparation.
- Whiteboards are difficult to transport and may not fit all meeting rooms.

Helpful Hints:

- Write large enough so that everyone can see.
- Use when brainstorming or group planning is needed.
- Plan an activity for the group to prevent boredom

Handouts

Handouts are written supplements that you can pass out to your audience to provide additional details or a summary of your presentation. They can also be supporting data worksheets, outlines, or even questionnaires that will give you the feedback you need to do a better job the next time.

Benefits

- Handouts eliminate the need for note taking.
- Provide an accurate record of the information being presented.
- The dissemination of additional information is possible.
- Information is available for absent or late presentation attendee.
- Handouts can be used with all types of presentation media.

Limitations:

- Because people can look ahead, the presenter may lose control.
- Handouts passed out in advance tend to cause attendees to prejudge the presenter. and/or the presentation.
- The noise from page turning is distracting.
- Poorly designed handouts reflect negatively on your presentation.

Helpful Hints:

- Prepare sufficient handouts for the group plus extras.
- Determine the best time to distribute the handouts and place them in a convenient location or pass them out.
- Distribute material before the presentation if you want the audience to follow along as you speak.
- Distribute material during the presentation if you have a reason for not wanting the audience to see it until you are ready to talk about it.
- Distribute material after the presentation if you want people to listen to you rather than read the material.
- If people are going to receive a handout that summarizes your presentation, let them know in advance so they won't need to take extensive notes.

Summary

The following are some general guidelines to consider when choosing and creating visual aids:

- Visuals should add to the presentation, not distract from it.
- Visual aids can only add to a good speech, they cannot rescue a poorly developed speech.
- Your visual aids must be clearly visible and understandable by the entire audience.
- Use simple fonts
- Avoid distributing objects to the audience while you are speaking.
- Practice with your visuals well ahead of time so that you can smoothly integrate them into your performance.
- Be prepared for disaster!
- Speak to your audience, not your visual aids.
- Keep video and audio presentations short and to the point.
- Try to have only one piece of information on a poster or overhead transparency.
- Statistical information is easier for your audience to understand when presented visually through charts and graphs.

Lesson 25 Group Communication

Definition of a Group Meeting

A meeting is a gathering of two or more people where purposive discourse occurs. Of course these purposes will vary.

A communication between two people is primarily an interchange dyadic communication. A group is larger: at least 3 people and perhaps as many as 15 or more.

Informal Group

Casual or informal group meetings are common. Here you casually chat over tea, meet after work, or get together for purely social reasons. You and your friends meet to socialize, to interact often spontaneously, without plan. Your business day is filled with such informal group meetings. Ironically, out of the need for frequent casual meetings may develop the need for more formal and directed meetings.

Formal Group

Often called task-oriented groups, formal groups often search for answers to problems, look for a course of action, make recommendations to a higher authority. This means that you and others may meet to change a policy, make decisions on how a specific problem should be solved, and decide on the beginning steps to implement a solution.

Formation of Groups

Groups go through four formative stages in becoming a group.

- **Forming:** Here the group tries to get started. It is the orientation phase for group members.
- **Storming:** Members begin to stake out their positions; they begin to have conflicts and arguments.
- **Norming:** Progress begins here. Members work to solve conflicts and recognize acceptable kinds of conduct.
- **Performing:** Here the group begins to achieve its goals.

Once you are part of a group seeking to solve a problem, one other thing occurs: The group begins to follow certain phases in solving the problem.

- **Orientation:** Here discussion is free flowing; people orally wander about, each trying to focus on asking questions. Here too, questions are numerous; Members try to inform, ask further questions.
- **Conflict:** After the preliminary sparring is over, members begin to offer opinions, evidence in support of their positions. At this phase initial conflicts occur. There may even be resistance to the agreed upon task.
- **Emergence:** Open exchanges continue; members begin to search for ways of truly solving the problem. Compromises occur, and there is a decrease in conflict and sincere movement toward decreasing differences in opinion.
- **Solutions:** A positive attitude exists at this phase. Options have been discussed, and criteria for measuring those options have been viewed. Now is the time to complete the task and agree upon a solution.

Purpose of Group Meetings

Meetings have two core purposes:

- To present information and to help solve problems.
- Obviously both purposes occur in all meetings.

Three kinds of meetings help achieve these objectives.

- Informational meetings
- Suggested solution meetings
- Problem-solving meetings

Informational meetings:

In these meetings the members learn, ask questions, and seek to understand. No problems are solved; no recommendation for change occurs. Participants come to the meeting with one pivotal purpose: to be informed, to understand the information.

Suggested solution meetings:

Visualize this situation a manager desires to receive input from her staff on an issue; he desires to review preliminary recommendations before solving the issue. The complete scenario may run something like this:

1. A supervisor senses a problem and desires a meeting to review options on addressing the problem. The goal: purely exploratory.
2. A memo or e-mail message is sent to all staffers asking for possible opposition on removing the problem.
3. Suggestions are tabulated and distributed to all respondents.
4. A meeting is called to discuss all possible options.

Problem-solving meetings:

Problem, solution, benefit, action these four steps trace the most common process in solving problems typical of the business world.

- (1) The major problem is presented early in the meeting,
- (2) participants suggest solutions, discussing and evaluating them
- (3) Participants arrive at a decision for further action.

Group Decision-Making

Standard agenda

Involves a careful, systematic approach to a problem. Groups make their decisions make use of a six-step guide called the standard agenda.

- **Problem identification:** What is the problem? What is wrong with the current situation?
- **Problem analysis:** View the current situation as a balance between restraining forces and helping forces. What are the forces in play in your group's situation?
- **Criteria selection:** What are the goals of the final decision?
- **Solution generation:** Generate as many solutions as possible. Avoid groupthink by listing many solutions.
- **Solution evaluation & selection:** Measure each solution against the criteria from step three.
- **Final decision:** There are many ways that a group can make a final decision, decide on a solution, or come to agreement. Some of the most popular ways of making the decision include:
 - **Consensus:** The group members all agree on the final decision through discussion and debate.
 - **Compromise:** Through discussion and readjustment of the final plan, group members come to agreement by giving up some of their demands.

- **Majority Vote:** The decision is based on the opinion of the majority of its members.
- **Decision by Leader:** The group gives the final decision to its leader.
- **Arbitration:** An external body or person makes a decision for the group.
- **Solution implementation:** Enact the chosen solution.

Alternate option

Brainstorming

Another option for decision-making is brainstorming. When brainstorming, group members are encouraged to generate as many ideas about a particular topic as they can. For instance, group members may use brainstorming to generate as many solutions as they can in step four of the standard agenda.

Tips for Structured Brainstorming

"The best way to get good ideas is to have lots of ideas."

Brainstorming is a blending of group problem solving and discussion. It operates on the premise that the more ideas that are generated, the greater the possibility of finding a workable solution to a given problem. There are three phases to brainstorming:

- (1) generation of ideas,
- (2) analysis,
- (3) Action planning.

Brainstorming is useful for:

- Generating many ideas in a short time
- Encouraging creative, spontaneous thinking
- Helping people temporarily suspend judgment
- Expanding or piggy-backing on ideas

Final decision

There are many ways that a group can make a final decision, decide on a solution, or come to agreement. Some of the most popular ways of making the decision include:

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- **Compromise:** Through discussion and readjustment of the final plan, group members come to agreement by giving up some of their demands.
- **Majority Vote:** The decision is based on the opinion of the majority of its members.
- **Decision by Leader:** The group gives the final decision to its leader.

- **Arbitration:** An external body or person makes a decision for the group.

Styles of Group Leadership

Authoritarian

Democratic

Laissez-faire

Planning the Meeting

As with formulating an informative or persuasive speech, take some time to:

- Define the purpose;
- Decide who to participate;
- Arrange for meeting date, time, & place;
- Create an agenda;
- Announce the meeting;
- Check on physical arrangements;

Procedures during the Meeting

- Begin with an opening statement
- Engage participants in discussion
- Understand the roles of the participants

Small group

Small group success depends on three types of functions being performed:

- Group task roles,
- Group building & maintenance roles, and
- Individual (Personal) roles.

Group task roles

Help to keep the group focused and directed towards achieving its goals.

Group building & maintenance roles

Help group members to stay involved, and ensure that everyone is able to contribute to their maximum potential.

Individual roles address

The personal needs of group members to ensure that the group functions in the best possible way these activities include the ways in which conflicts and disruptive behaviors are handled.

Group task roles

Initiating:

This is any action taken to get the group members started on working together towards their purpose.

Information, or opinion, seeking:

This is the act of asking for facts, relevant information, suggestions or ideas about a group concern. This can be done through normal group interaction or if fresh ideas are required, a full brainstorming session or other ideas generation technique can be used.

Information, or opinion, giving:

This is offering information up to the group in the form of facts, beliefs, opinions or ideas.

Clarifying or elaborating:

Interpreting ideas, clearing up confusions, identifying alternatives, and raising related issues, are all ways of clarifying and elaborating on things the group is discussing.

Summarizing:

This is the act of pulling together related ideas, restating suggestions after they have been fully discussed, or offering a decision or conclusion for the group to accept or reject.

Consensus seeking:

This is the act of testing whether the group is nearing a conclusion or decision. It is aimed at assessing the extent to which the group is in agreement.

Devil's advocate:

This is an essential act of leadership and is performed when there is a suspicion that the group has reached agreement or consensus on an issue too quickly and easily.

Consultants:

Design or research groups have some special leadership needs because they often include artists, researchers or other 'specialists', who are often unwilling to submit themselves, their art, or their ideas to the 'limitations' of group process.

Group Building & Maintenance Roles

- Encouraging

- Expressing group feelings
- Compromising
- Gate keeping

This is the function of keeping communication channels open within the group at all times. This means two things,

- restraining those who tend to talk at all times and at length, and
- Drawing out those who tend to stay quiet and withdrawn, who find it difficult to enter a discussion or who are easily talked over by others.

- Setting standards
- Housekeeping
- Self-understanding
- Inter-personal understanding
- Active listening
- Managing conflict (Conflict is the double-edged sword of group functioning.)
- Stopping conflict escalation
- Recognition

Participant roles in a group meeting

- Organizer
- Clarifier
- Questioner
- Factual contributor (Presenting factual information in an arrogant or overbearing manner will create negative reactions be positive.)
- Energizer
- Idea creator
- Critical tester
- Conciliator (You as a conciliator attempt to find a middle ground, seek to find a compromise.)
- Helper of others

Lesson 26 Elements of Effective Written Communication

Elements of Effective Written Communication

Because written communication plays such a significant role in our economy and in the daily routines of the vast majority of organizations, an understanding of the essentials of written communication is critical. You must know what you want to say and how to say it.

In order to choose the right words and sentences for your letters, you need to be familiar with the elements of effective written communication. The elements are:

1. Courtesy

2. Correctness
3. Conciseness
4. Clarity
5. Concreteness
6. Completeness

Courtesy

Review of actual business correspondence reveals that special attention should be devoted to assuring the courtesy of business communication.

You-Attitude

Writing with a you-attitude shows sincere concern for the reader. Emphasizing the reader's (you) viewpoint rather than the writer's viewpoint demonstrates sincerity. Merely replacing a few I's, we, our and my with you and your throughout a letter, however, will not guarantee the presence of the you-attitude. To establish a you-attitude, you must create a positive state of mind through your suggestions and decisions.

Understanding some basic truths about human nature helps we humanize our business messages. These truths are:

- People are self-centered
- People are defensive
- People are not perfect
- People expect courtesy
- People do the best they can

People are self-centered

Being self-centered does not mean egoistic and conceited. It means that people want to know what good they will get out of doing business with us. When a business executive receives mail, s/he asks two questions:

- what's this
- Why me.

People are defensive

Put another way, its human nature to be suspicious of promises and to resist (at least initially) even the most well-meaning criticism.

People are not perfect

Error is a part of life, but no one likes having mistakes pointed out. Effective writers focus on solving the problem not pointing out mistakes.

Incorporating You-Attitude

"We noticed that your signatures were missing. Could you please come in sometime today to sign?"

People expect courtesy

Think about the kind of service you want, when we go into a store. We want the sales person to pay attention to us, to make us feel that our business is important.

People do the best they can

Effective writers assume their readers are acting honestly, fairly, and intelligently.

Guidelines for Courteous Writing

Exclude irritating expressions

Many words and phrases that are used effectively in oral and interpersonal communication are perceived as inappropriate in written communication.

For example:

- "We find it difficult to understand."
- "Your lack of communication ..."
- "As we have explained to you many times..."
- "Why can't you understand our position?"

Include meaningful apologies

Business correspondence often calls for sincere apologies or a willingness to grant the action that was requested.

When you receive a discourteous letter that incorrectly accuses you, the wisest approach is to reply in a courteous manner. By using this approach, you may win a life-time customer. Another effective way to enhance goodwill is to apologize for a mistake or error even before the customer discovers it. For less serious mistakes or errors, a printed form may be suitable; but when the mistakes or errors are serious, a personalized letter is the only appropriate communication medium.

Include courteous wording

Omitting discourteous wording does not necessarily guarantee courteous messages. Although some messages are void of discourteous word, they can be overly harsh or blunt. Notice how the blunt, harsh wording of the material in the example below can be revised to be more pleasant.

Blunt, harsh wording:

“You did not read my recent letter.”

Courteous writing:

“Please refer to my June 10 letter.”

Respond in a timely manner

Although one person’s priority may be another person’s timewaster, prompt attention to customer questions and needs is imperative.

Positive wording

In written communication, the use of positive wording is essential for building goodwill. The elimination of words that have negative connotations will provide a pleasing and comfortable link with the reader.

- **Negative wording:** You do not qualify for the free gift because you did not respond within ten days.
- **Positive wording:** You probably did not notice that your order was mailed after our special gift order had expired.
- **Negative wording:** We are very sorry that we cannot send you our Communication Skills booklet by December 5.
- **Positive wording:** The publication department has assured me that you will have the Communication Skills booklet by January 20.

Bias-free language

Most of us think of ourselves as being sensitive, unbiased, ethical, and fair. But being fair and objective isn’t enough; to establish a good relationship with your audience, you must also appear to be fair. Bias-free language avoids unethical, embarrassing blunders in language related to gender, race, ethnicity, age, and disability.

Gender bias

Avoid sexist language by using the same label for every one (don’t call a woman “chairperson” & then call a man “chairman”). Reword sentences to use them or to use no pronoun at all. The preferred title for women in business is Ms., unless the individual asks to be addressed as Miss or Mrs. or has some other title, such as Dr.

Replacing

Businessman	with	Businessperson
Chairman	with	Chairperson
Man-made	with	Artificial
Spokesman	with	Spokesperson
Mankind	with	Humankind

Racial and ethnic bias

The central principle is to avoid language suggesting that members of a racial or an ethnic group have stereotypical characteristics. The best solution is to avoid identifying people by race or ethnic origin unless such a label is relevant.

Examples:

- “His black assistant speaks more clearly than he does” (Racial-bias)
- “His assistant speaks more clearly than he does”. (Reader-friendly)
- “Mr. X is an unusually tall Asian” (Racial-bias)
- “Mr. X is tall” (Reader-friendly)

Age bias

As with gender, race, and ethnic background, mention the age of a person only when it is relevant. When referring to older people, avoid age avoid adjectives like frail, old etc.

Example:

- “Mr. X, aged 55, has just joined our Technical Department” (Age-bias)
- “Mr. X has just joined our Technical Department”. (Reader-friendly)

Disability bias

No painless label exists for people with a physical, mental, sensory, or emotional impairment. Avoid mentioning a disability unless it is pertinent. However if you must refer to someone’s disability, avoid terms as “handicapped”, “crippled”, or “retarded”. Put the person first and the disability second.

Example:

- “Crippled workers face many barriers on the job”.
- (Disability-bias) “Workers with physical disabilities face many barriers on the job” (Reader-friendly)

Lesson 27 Elements of Effective Written Communication

Correctness

At the core of correctness is proper grammar, punctuation, and spelling. However, a message may be perfect grammatically and mechanically but still insult or lose a customer. The term correctness, as applied to business messages also means the following three characteristics:

- Use the right level of language
- Check accuracy of words, information, and data.

- Use correct grammar and punctuation.
- Check spelling.

Use the right level of language

Writing at a level appropriate for your reader is crucial. The words you use and the way you use to form sentences affect comprehension and also convey an unwritten message. If you write in a stiff, formal way, you will give the impression of being formal, whether or not you intend to be.

Formal

“Please inform me of the manner in which you intend to liquidate this balance”.

Informal

“Pl. let me know when you plan to pay the outstanding balance of your account”.

Formal	Informal
ascertain	find out
endeavor	try
procure	get
utilize	use

Check accuracy of words, information and data

Effective business communication requires the use of accurate words, information, and data. The goodwill that perhaps required years to develop can be destroyed with even a minor error.

Use correct grammar and punctuation

Many people in business organizations incorrectly apply principles of grammar and punctuation. The proper use of these two language fundamentals is crucial.

Even if the content of the document is appropriate and contains the essential qualities of written communication, the presence of incorrect grammar and punctuation will have a negative impact on the message.

Check spelling

Administrative assistants provide a valuable service to supervisors, managers, and executives by ensuring the correct spelling of words. While the first draft of a written message is the responsibility of the typist, the final product is the responsibility of the person signing the document.

Conciseness

Effective writing is concise each word, sentence, and paragraph counts. Conciseness should not be interpreted to mean brevity, which will result in an incomplete message. To illustrate, a 150-word letter that could be written in 100 words without a loss in meaning is not concise. A two-page letter cannot be shortened without a loss in meaning is concise.

Concise communication does the following:

Eliminate wordy expressions

Using unneeded words increases the length of sentences and forces readers to carry excess words in their minds. In the following two paragraphs, the writer was not careful in selecting words.

Include only relevant material

The effective, concise message should omit not only unnecessary wordy expressions but also irrelevant statements. To be sure you include only relevant facts, observe the following suggestions:

- Stick to the purpose of the message.
- Delete irrelevant words and rambling sentence.
- Omit information obvious to the receiver; do not repeat at length what that person has already told you. If you feel it is important to remind the audience of known information, subordinate the familiar information.
- Avoid long introductions, unnecessary explanations, excessive adjectives and propositions, pompous words.
- Get to the important point tactfully and concisely.

Clarity

Getting the meaning from your head into the head of your reader accurately is the purpose of clarity. Of course, you know this is not simple. We all carry our own unique ideas, experiences, and interpretations with words. Clarity can be achieved by:

- i. Choosing precise, concrete & familiar words
- ii. Constructing effective sentences & paragraphs

Choosing precise, concrete and familiar words

Clarity is achieved in part through a balance between precise language and familiar language. When you use precise or concrete language you select exactly the right words to convey your meaning.

Long word

1. During the preceding year, the company was able to accelerate the productive operations.
2. The president acceded to the proposition to nullify the contractual relationship

Short word

1. Last year the company was able to speed up operations
2. The president agreed to break the contract.

Concrete words

The dividing line between abstract and concrete words is hard to define. Abstract words are vague.

Abstract	Concrete
sizeable	loss 4% loss
near	future on Friday

Constructing effective sentences & paragraphs

At the core of the clarity is the sentence. Important characteristics to consider are length, unity, coherence, and emphasis.

Length

Generally, short sentences are preferred. The suggested average sentence length should be about 17 to 20 words. Because variety in sentence length adds interest to writing, adopt a range of from 3 to 30 or more words. But when a sentence exceeds 40 words, try to rewrite it into more than one sentence. Also, if all sentences are short (under 10 words), the result is overly simple.

Unity

In a sentence whether simple, compound, or complex unity means that you have one main idea and any other ideas in the sentence must be closely related to it.

Emphasis

The technique of emphasis is used when you want certain words, phrases, clauses, or sentences to stand out. Some of the emphasis techniques that you can employ are position, repetition, quantity, and mechanics.

Lesson 28 Elements of Effective Written Communication

Concreteness

Communicating concretely means being specific, definite and vivid rather than vague and general. Concrete writing makes specific references to persons, places, objects, & actions while abstract man's making general references to these items.

To make your writing concrete you should:

- a. Include as much specific information as possible.
- b. Use active rather than passive verbs.

- c. Use vivid, image-building words.

Include as much specific information as possible

An effective way to overcome this dilemma is to provide as much specific information as possible rather than general information.

- Change: She is a fast typist.
- To: She types @ of 80 words/min

Example of a general statement

- Change: He got a good score in his MBA Program.
- To: His GPA in 2000 was 3.9 on a four point scale.

The following is a partial list of particularly troublesome words.

large	good
small	around
old	convenient
young	little
majority	large

Use vivid, image-building words

Among the devices you can use to make your messages forceful, vivid, and specific are sensory appeals, comparisons, concrete nouns, and well-chosen adjectives and adverbs.

Examples:

Change: This report is weak.

To: The following flaws weaken the quality of this report:

- The numerous grammatical errors
- The inaccurate information that is presented, and
- The absence of feasible recommendations.”

Change: This is a long letter.

To This letter is three times as long as you said it would be.

Completeness

Incomplete messages quickly increase the organization’s cost. Any time a message is prepared that requires the preparation of another message, the cost of communicating doubles. Incomplete messages are costly in other ways as well because they can result in:

1. Loss of goodwill.

2. Loss of valued customers.
3. Loss of sales.
4. Waste of time trying to make sense out of an incomplete message.
5. Cost of returning merchandise because of an incomplete order.

The best way to determine if you have provided enough information is to subject your writing to questions like Who? What? When? Where? Why? How? – 5Ws & H. If you have provided clear answers to these questions, your response is likely to be complete. If you cannot answer these questions, you probably should consider adding additional information.

As you strive for completeness, keep the following guidelines in mind:

- Provide all necessary information.
- Answer all questions asked.
- Give something extra, when desirable.

Provide all necessary information

When you initiate a message, check to make sure you have provided all the information the reader needs for thorough, accurate understanding. One way to help make your message complete is to answer the five W questions who, what, when, where, why and any other essentials such as how.

Answer all questions asked

Whenever you reply to an inquiry, try to answer all questions stated and implied. A colleague or prospective customer's reaction to an incomplete reply is likely to be unfavorable. The customer may think the respondent is careless or purposely trying to conceal information. In general, "Omissions cast suspicions." Whether you are answering an inquiry about your product or recommending a former employee for a new job. If you have no information on a particular question, say so clearly. If you have unfavorable information in answer to certain questions, handle your reply with both tact and honesty.

Give something extra; when desirable

Sometimes you must do more than answer the customers' specific questions.

Lesson 29 Preparing for Effective Business Writing

Effective business writers prepare for writing. In fact, much of their writing success can be attributed to the quality of their preparation. Occasionally, preparing to write may be as time consuming as the actual writing.

Several steps are found within each of the stages. The following outline identifies these steps.

1. Planning Stage

- Determine your purpose

- Consider your reader
- Choose your idea
- Determine the appropriate content

2. Organizing Stage

- Outline the topics you plan to include
- Determine the order of the topics

3. Drafting Stage

- Develop appropriate beginning paragraph
- Compose the body
- Develop appropriate ending paragraph

4. Editing Stage

5. Proofreading stage

Planning Stage

The more time you devote to planning your message, the more effective it will be because planning will help you determine what material to include given the nature of the situation and the reader. During the planning stage you determine your purpose, consider your reader, and determine the appropriate content for your message.

Determine your purpose

For some people, purpose is connected to vocation—meaningful, satisfying work. For others, their purpose lies in their responsibilities to their family or friends. Others seek meaning through spirituality or religious beliefs. Some people may find their purpose clearly expressed in all these aspects of life.

Consider your reader

Effective writing is readily understood by your reader. Unless you are familiar with your reader and have considered his/her background, you may have difficulty focusing on his/her needs.

Choose your ideas

With your purpose and receiver in mind, the next step is to choose the ideas for your message. If you are answering a letter, underline the main points to discuss and jot your ideas in the margin.

Determine the appropriate content

Determining the content for a letter in which you are responding to a request is easier than when you are initiating the communication relationship. When responding to a request, you simply answer the

questions asked in the originating letter, adding any additional information that you feel would be helpful to your reader.

To determine appropriate content, you might find answering the following questions helpful.

1. What information is relevant for this situation, given the purpose of the message and the reader's needs?
2. What information should be included to make the message complete?
3. If I were the recipient of this message, what information would I find helpful?
4. What material needs to be included to make the message conform to the content customarily found in the type of message I am preparing.

Lesson 30 Preparing for Effective Business Writing

Organizing Stage

Outline the topics

Once the broad areas to be included in your message have been identified, your next step is to outline the. This step involves identifying the various subtopics to be discussed within each of the broad topics. Several methods can be used in developing topics:

1. Direct method
2. Indirect method

Direct method

The direct method involves presenting a general statement first, followed by specific supporting statements. This method is generally preferred when presenting positive or good-news information because the reader is immediately given the information of greater interest. The supporting information, which is of lesser interest, can be presented next.

Indirect method

The indirect method, which is more appropriate for negative-news messages, presents the specific information first, followed by the conclusion.

Determine the appropriate order of the topics

When you are determining the order of the topics, you should review your outline, keeping the following questions in mind.

1. Are the ideas of equal importance presented in a parallel manner?
2. Is the sequence of the topics appropriate for the development method I am using (direct, indirect)?

3. Is the sequence of the topics likely to add clarity to my message?
4. Are related topics properly sequenced? 5. Are the topics presented in the sequence recommended for the type of the message I am preparing?

Lesson 31 Preparing for Effective Business Writing

Drafting Stage

Once you have completed the planning and organizing stages, you are ready to draft the message. The beginning and ending paragraphs of your messages are critical to their effectiveness. Because they usually occupy positions of emphasis, they are likely to be carefully scrutinized by the reader.

Developing opening paragraphs the following suggestions help improve the effectiveness of the opening paragraph:

1. Make sure the beginning is appropriate for the reader.
2. Make sure the beginning is appropriate for the situation. Normally, in good-news letters, begin with the good news; in neutral or direct-request letters, begin with the main idea or request; in disappointing-newsletters, buffer the beginning with neutral or information which the reader will agree; and in persuasive messages, begin with information that will catch the reader's attention.
3. Avoid the inclusion of negative information or discourteous wording by emphasizing what can be done rather than what cannot be done.
4. Use a you-viewpoint (rather than an I-viewpoint) in the opening.
5. Use a fast-start beginning rather than a slow beginning in which you provide information that is obvious to the reader.
6. Keep the beginning paragraph fairly short.

Make sure the beginning paragraph possesses unity and coherence.

In a direct-request letter, the opening sentence can represent the request. In the first of the following two paragraphs the reader will not know why he/she received a letter after reading the opening. In the revised paragraph, notice how much more quickly the reader will learn the purpose of the letter.

Change: I am a student at XYZ business school and am currently enrolled in MBA program. One of the projects in the class is to make an in-depth financial analysis of some of the leading companies in Pakistan. I have selected your company for this project. (The main idea which was to request an annual report for the related company - is not presented in the beginning paragraph.)

To: Would you please send me an annual report for use in making a financial analysis of your company? Making a thorough analysis of the financial condition of your company is one of the requirements for the MBA program I am enrolled in at XYZ Business School.

Ending paragraph

In the ending you have opportunity to do two things:

- (i) Concentrate on the action you desire the reader to
- (ii) Show courtesy towards the reader.

Suggestions for improving the effectiveness of the ending paragraph of your messages are:

1. State the desired action clearly & completely.
2. State that is to perform the desired action if the action is to be performed by someone other than the reader.
3. State how the action is to be performed.
4. State when the action is to be performed, if appropriate.
5. Make the action easy to be performed.
6. Include reader-benefit material, if appropriate.
7. Show appreciation to the reader, if appropriate. Remember, until the reader does something for you, thanking him/her is inappropriate.
8. Avoid the inclusion of negative information in the ending.
9. Offer to be of assistance, if appropriate.
10. Keep the ending paragraph as short as circumstances will allow.

4. Editing Stage

Evaluate for compliance with principles of effective communication. The editing process will be simplified if you evaluate your work, keeping in mind the following questions.

1. Is the information in your message correct?
2. Is the information relevant to your audience?
3. Have you provided enough information to satisfy your reader's needs?
4. Have you covered all your points in the most logical order?
5. Do the most important ideas receive the most space, and are they placed in the most prominent position?
6. Would the message be more convincing if it were arranged in another sequence?
7. Do you repeat yourself?
8. Are details scattered that need to be grouped together?
9. Have you answered all the questions asked by the reader?
10. Have you provided additional info which your reader will appreciate having?

As you proofread you should check for:

1. Accuracy of dates, figures, amounts, numbers, and so forth
2. Misspelled words
3. Typographic errors

4. Omissions and additions of material
5. Proper sequencing of material
6. Correct format

Lesson 32 Parts of Business Letter

Parts of letter

- Essential parts
- Non-essential parts

Essential parts

- Letterhead
- Date
- Inside address
- Salutation
- Body
- Complimentary close
- Signature

Specimen Business Letter

Letter Head

Company Letterhead

With address/telephone/fax

Date	August 5, 2001 Mr. / Ms. First name Last name Title or Department
Inside Address	Company Name 2000 Street, Suite 100 City, State Zip
Salutation	Dear Mr. / Ms. Last Name: I am writing to request information about Accommodations in the Seattle area. Our company is
Body	sending six senior managers to Seattle to attend an executive training program at the University for two months in the fall.
Body	I understand that there are several different housing options available for international visitors: university residence halls, home stays, hotels, and apartments. Which would you recommend?
Body	I would appreciate any information you could send me.
Complimentary Close	Sincerely, First name last name
Signature	First name Last name Position

Non-essential parts

- Addressee notation
- Attention line/ Reference
- Subject line
- Reference initials

- Enclosure
- Copy notation/Carbon copy (CC)
- Mailing notation
- Post scrip

Parts of Business Letter

- Heading - letterhead
- Date
- Inside address
- Salutation
- Attention line
- Subject
- Body
- Complimentary close
- Signature area
- Reference initials
- Enclosure
- Copies line/ Mailing notation
- Postscripts

Heading -letterhead

A heading shows where the letter comes from, and if it is letterhead stationery, it is usually at the top center of the letter. If you are not using letterhead stationery, your return address, but not your name, is typed directly above the date about 2 inches from the top.

Date

The date is typewritten two to six lines below the last line of the letterhead. The date is placed at the left margin or so it ends with the right margin. Date sequence preferred is:

December 5, 2005 – month, day, year; or in figures like 12/5/05 (American style). In Europe & Asia – 5/12/05.

Inside address

left-hand margin. Includes name & address of the individual, group or organization.

Salutation and complimentary close

The salutation (or opening greeting) is typed on the 2nd line below the inside address, two lines above the body, & even with the left margin.

Main body

The main body of the letter is divided logically into the paragraphs. Paragraphs are conventionally separated by two line spaces for clarity; whether or not the first line of each is indented from the left hand margin.

Complimentary close

The words (such as sincerely yours) that conventionally come immediately before the signature of a letter and express the sender's regard for the receiver. Called also complimentary closing. When the letter is informal, additional closes are often used, like Warm regards, Best regards & Best wishes. From UK and Asia closing is; faithfully yours.

Signature area

You can include in the signature area several identifications: name of your company, your signature, your typewritten name, and your business tile.

Addressee notation

Addressee notation is written to make the readership of the letter restricted. It is written two lines above inside address. It is written in capital letters.

Subject line

It directs the reader's thoughts to the matter in hand. Though Subject line is not an essential part of a letter but it is commonly used in business letters where higher management is your recipient, as they usually don't have time to read complete letters.

Example:-

Subject: Order No. 0012254

The Subject line is usually written one line below the salutation.

Reference initials

Reference initials always appear at the left margin and are typed one or two lines below the last line of the signatures.

Enclosure

Putting something other than the letter in the same envelope, such as a cheque, resume, price list, leaflet or any other document for reference is called enclosing something with the letter. Indicate this simply by typing Enclosures one, two or three lines below the complementary close and signature.

Mailing notation

Mailing notation words such as Special Delivery, Certified, or Registered Mail, when applicable, may be typed a double space below the date line and at least a double space before the inside address.

Postscript

To emphasize a point already in your letter or to include a brief personal message unrelated to the letter, a postscript, typed or handwritten may be added ("P.S.," "PS," or "PS:") below everything else typed on the page.

Example:

- Enc. (or Encs, for more than one item)
- Enclosures 2 (two documents are enclosed)

Enclosed:

- 1) CV
- 2) Attested Copy of NIC
- 3) Attested Final Transcript

Lesson 33 Direct-Request Letters

Writing routine letters

Whenever you ask for something information, action, products, adjustments, and references you are making a request. To be as clear as possible, you as a writer need to imagine all the ways a request might be understood and then carefully choose your words to avoid drawbacks.

Strategy for routine requests

Like all routine messages, routine requests may be thought of as having three parts: an opening, a body, and a close. Using the direct approach, you place your main idea (a clear statement of the request) in the opening.

State your request up front

Begin routine requests by placing your request first – up front is where it stands out and gets the most attention.

- **Pay attention to tone:-**

Even though you expect a favorable response, the tone of your initial request is important. Instead of demanding action (“Send me your catalogue no 33A”), soften your request with words like “please” and “I would appreciate.”

- **Assume your audience will comply:-**

An impatient demand for rapid service isn’t necessary. Generally make the assumption that your audience will comply with your request once the reason for it is clearly understood.

- **Avoid beginning with personal introductions:-**

Don’t be tempted to begin your request with a personal introduction such as “I am the senior corporate writer in the corporate relations department of XYZ, and I am looking for information that”

- **Punctuate questions and polite requests differently:-**

A polite request in question form requires no question mark: “Would you please help us determine whether Mr. Aslam is a suitable applicant for this position.” A direct question within your message does require a question mark: “Did Mr. Aslam demonstrate an ability to work smoothly with clients?”

- **Be specific:-**

State precisely what you want. For example, if you require the latest census figures from a government agency, be sure to say whether you want a page or two of summary figures or a detailed report running several thousand pages.

Explain and justify your request

Explain the middle section of your message to explain your initial request. Make the explanation a smooth and logical outgrowth of your opening remarks.

When using a series of questions, just keep a few basics in mind:

- Ask the important questions first.
- Ask only relevant questions.
- Deal with only one topic per question.
- Request specific action in a courteous close

Close your message with three important elements:

1. A specific request,
2. Information about how you can be reached, and
3. An expression of appreciation or goodwill.

Direct-inquiry letters

Two types of direct-inquiry letters discussed here are:

- A. Requesting information about products or services
- B. Requesting information about people

Requesting information about products or services

Organizations that receive letters of inquiry about their products or services find their responses to these letters can be an effective sales technique.

The suggested plan for a direct-inquiry letter includes the following elements:

- An opening that contains the primary request and secondary requests;
- An explanation that includes the reasons for the requests or provides additional helpful background information;
- A closing that suggests the action you wish the recipient to take; and that expresses appreciation for assistance.

Lesson 34 Direct-Request Letters

B. Requesting information about a person

Inquiries about people involve two considerations:

- First is the need to respect the rights legal and moral.
- Second is the need to structure the questions around the job involved.

Benefit

1. Respect human rights, both legal and moral.
2. Ask only for info related to the job.
3. Stress fact, write for business use and when authorized and treat confidentially.
4. Structure the questions around the job.

The suggested plan for a letter in which information about a job applicant is requested includes the following elements:

1. An opening that mentions the name of the person who has given the reader's name as a reference;
2. A list of questions that you would like to have answered.
3. A brief discussion of the common duties of the job for which the applicant has applied.
4. A courteous, action-oriented closing.

Indirect-inquiry letters

The indirect-inquiry letter is used to request general information rather than answers to specific questions. The opening of an indirect-inquiry letter can be less specific than the opening of a direct-

inquiry letter. The explanatory sections of direct- and indirect-inquiry letters may not vary much from one another.

Claim letters

The manner in which an organization deals with the claims it receives will affect its reputation. When you have a legitimate complaint about a product or service, you should make it known to the manufacturer or supplier.

The following list summarizes the bases for claims about service:

1. Supply not received.
2. Part of the merchandise not received.
3. Wrong merchandise received.
4. Damaged merchandise received.
5. Merchandise received too late.
6. Merchandise sent to wrong address.
7. Error made in prices of merchandise.
8. Statement received for bill already made.
9. Employee incompetence or rudeness.

Qualities of effective claim letters

Before you begin the process of preparing a claim letter, you will want to be familiar with the following qualities of effective claim letter:

1. An effective claim letter does not threaten.
2. An effective claim letter presents all the facts relevant to the situation.
3. The writer of an effective claim letter does not take his/her anger out on the recipient.
4. An effective claim letter, by containing you-attitude material, will help the recipient realize the advantage of making an adjustment.
5. An effective claim letter makes a definite request, such as one of the following:
 - a) Replacement of the product or service.
 - b) Partial or full refund on the purchase price of the product or service.
 - c) Replacement shipment, which contains the merchandise that was ordered.
 - d) Repair of the defective product.
 - e) Cancellation of an order or a portion of the order.
 - f) Correction of an error in billing, such as overcharging for merchandise, tax, and shipping.
 - g) Clarification of a procedure.

Structure of effective claim letters

The opening paragraph in a claim letter should mention the nature of the claim. The X-photocopier we purchased from you on Aug. 22 is being returned with a request that it be replaced with a new one. Explanatory material is presented as precisely and directly in an impersonal and courteous manner.

Effective action-oriented closing

I will appreciate your replacing the X-photocopier soon so we can provide a fast and efficient photocopying service to our conference participants.

Order letters

Normally, order blanks or purchase orders are used when ordering merchandise by mail. When placing an order, you need not excite your reader; just state your needs clearly and directly. Most orders refer to a product that the reader knows about, so these messages are usually processed without objection. Order letters are comprised of three distinct content components:

1. Pertinent information about the items being ordered;
2. Directions for shipping the merchandise, including desired receipt date (if appropriate) and the desired shipping location (if different from your address); and the
3. Method of payment.

Lesson 35 Direct-Request Letters

Letters of invitation

Letters of invitation include speaking invitations as well as informal and formal social invitations.

Speaking invitation

When writing a letter inviting someone to make a presentation, the inclusion of vital information about the event will help prevent inconvenience or misunderstanding. Important details to include in the letter of invitation are:

1. Name of the group before which the presentation will be made;
2. A few characteristics about the group to help the speaker tailor his/her remarks to the audience;
 - a) The desired length of the presentation;
 - b) The topic of the presentation;
 - c) The date, time, and the location;
 - d) Any transportation and/or lodging arrangements;
 - e) Amount of honorarium, if one is being given.

Social-invitation letters

Most social invitation letters are considered informal. When more formality is needed, a formal invitation, either printed or handwritten should be considered.

Reservation letters

Provide all information, like: type of room needed (single, double, suite); number of persons to occupy the room; arrival and departure date and time, and a request for confirmation.

For putting this information, follow the plan like:

1. A fast-start opening which identifies the type of room desired and the days needed;
2. A section which mentions arrival and departure times;
3. A courteous, action-oriented closing, which mentions your desire for a confirmation.

Letters requesting favors

When a favor is requested, the writer has a special reason for expressing his/her ideas tactfully and courteously as well as persuasively. The individual requesting for a favor should first ask two questions

1. Have I sufficient reason for making this request?
2. Am I asking a favor of a person reasonably expected to be willing to grant the favor?

The letter should have a positive tone, be courteous, and show appreciation for the recipient's granting of the favor. The recipient should not be thanked in advance.

Lesson 36 Good-News Letters

Types of good-news letters:

Many situations in the business world require the preparation of good-news letters. When well written, these letters help organizations improve their relationships with their customers and clients. The types of good-news letters are:

1. Letters replying to inquiries, extending credits,
2. Letters granting adjustments
3. Letters acknowledging orders
4. Letters granting favors
5. Letters of congratulation
6. Letters accepting invitations

What characteristics do good-news letters possess?

Good-news letters can be identified by the following characteristics:

1. Begin with the good news or main idea
2. Use a fast-start opening
3. Provide explanatory details or information of primary and secondary importance.
4. Incorporate a you-viewpoint
5. Incorporate an appropriate closing

Letters that provide information about products or services

Letter responding to an inquiry about a product or service should have a fast-start opening the inclusion of sales-promotion, or reader-benefit material

Letters responding to an inquiry about a person

Two situations necessitate the preparation of such letters responding to an inquiry about a person. These situations occur when you are asked to provide information about.

1. A person whom you serve as a reference (such as former or current employee) and
2. A job applicant's work performance (also for a person's credit worthiness).

Notice the difference between the slow-start of the first of the following two paragraphs and the fast-start of the revised opening.

Letters responding to indirect inquiries

A number of the characteristics found in letters responding to direct inquiries are also found in letters responding to indirect inquiries. These characteristics are a fast-start opening, the presentation of material of primary importance first, followed by the presentation of material of secondary importance, and a friendly, courteous closing. Also, when you are preparing a letter in response to an indirect inquiry, the inclusion of reader benefit material is more appropriate.

1. A fast-start opening that mentions your compliance with the initial inquiry / request – but that avoids presenting obvious information
2. A section that includes additional information that might be helpful to the reader, including sales-promotion, or reader-benefit material
3. A friendly, courteous closing that expresses your willingness to provide future assistance.

Letters granting adjustments

Because the situation stems from an unhappy experience, you have two special needs.

1. Need to overcome negative impressions
2. Need to regain lost confidence

One is the need to overcome the negative impressions the experience leading to the adjustment has formed in the reader's mind. The other is the need to regain any confidence in your company, or its services the reader may have lost from the experience. Keeping in mind the two special needs, we come up with this specific plan for the message granting an adjustment:

1. Begin directly – with the good news
2. Incidentally identify the correspondence that you are answering
3. Avoid negatives that recall the problem
4. Regain lost confidence through explanation or corrective action
5. End with a friendly, positive comment

Letters that grant favors

Writing a letter to grant a favor should be one of the easiest letters to write. Suggested plan for a letter that grants a favor:

1. A cordial, courteous opening that mentions the granting of favor
2. A discussion of restriction or limitations that pertain to the granting of the favor
3. A discussion, if appropriate, of any action the reader is to take in accepting the favor
4. A cordial, courteous closing that is action oriented when appropriate

The opening paragraph of a letter that grants a favor should be cheerful and cordial.

One of the essential qualities of letters of congratulation is sincerity. Tired artificial phrases indicate a lack of sincerity and destroy the goodwill that congratulatory letters should create. The suggested plan for a congratulatory letter includes the following elements:

1. An opening that congratulates the reader for his/her accomplishment or achievement
2. A section that expresses your understanding of the importance of the accomplishment or achievement
3. A courteous closing that extends best wishes for continued success

Letters accepting invitations

A letter in which a special-business invitation or an invitation to an event is accepted should convey appreciation and enthusiasm and should be sent as soon as possible after receiving the invitation.

- a. To verify the accuracy of these details in case an error has been made, and
- b. To provide a record in case the invitation becomes misplaced.

The suggested plan for a letter of acceptance for a social-business invitation includes the following elements:

1. An opening in which the invitation is cordially and enthusiastically accepted
2. A review of the important details about the event
3. A courteous closing that expresses appreciation for the invitation

Letters acknowledging orders

The reasons for acknowledging an order are to inform the customer that his / her order has been received and that it has been shipped (or will be shipped), to express appreciation to the customer for his / her order, and to build goodwill.

A letter that acknowledges an order should begin with a fast-start opening which provides the best news first. The reader will be more interested in learning about the status of his / her order than receiving a "thank you." Although including a note of thanks in the opening is appropriate, information about the status of the order should be presented first.

Lesson 37 Disappointing-News Letters

A variety of situations arise in the business world that requires the preparation of letters in which disappointing-news is conveyed. Your goal in writing these letters is to state the refusal in an inoffensive way to avoid alienating your reader. Developing strategies for disappointing-news letters

When delivering disappointing-news, you have five goals:

1. To convey the disappointing-news,
2. To ensure its acceptance,
3. To maintain reader's goodwill,
4. To maintain organization's good image, and
5. To reduce/eliminate need for future correspondence

Accompanying so many goals in a single message is not easy. But you can make your bad-news messages effective by:

1. Adopting an audience-centered tone
2. Organize your message to meet your reader's needs and expectations by using direct or indirect approach.

Creating an audience-centered tone

It's not what you say but how you say it. Your tone contributes to your message's effectiveness by helping your readers:

- Accept that your disappointing-news represents a firm decision.
- Understand that, under the circumstances, your decision was fair and reasonable.
- Remain well prepared toward your business.
- Preserve their pride.

When establishing tone, strive for firmness, fairness, goodwill and respect Disappointing-news involves emotions. You must acknowledge these emotions empathic response. But you can't let those emotions interfere with your message.

Adopt audience-centered tone by paying attention to three things:

1. Using the "you"-attitude

Using the "you" attitude is crucial to every message you write, but it's especially important in disappointing-news messages.

2. Choose Positive words

You can ease disappointment by using positive words rather than negative, counterproductive ones.

Avoid a negative tone Use a positive tone

- I can't understand what you mean Pl. clarify your request
- The damage won't be fixed for a week. The item will be repaired next week
- The breakage was not our fault. The merchandise was broken during shipping.
- The enclosed statement is wrong. Please recheck the enclosed statement.

3. Use respectful language

When you use language that conveys respect and avoids an accusing tone, you protect your audience's pride. For instance, when refusing a claim, try using third-person, impersonal, passive language to explain your audience's mistakes in an inoffensive way.

Say, "The appliance won't work after being immersed in water" instead of "You shouldn't have immersed the appliance in water".

When the audience is at fault, the "you" attitude is better observed by avoiding the word "you".

Organizing your message

Using the direct approach

You know that your audience is likely to prefer the disappointing-news first, or if the situation is minor and the news will cause your audience little pain or disappointment, use the direct approach.

Use the direct approach

When your negative answer or information will have little personal impact the direct approach is also appropriate when you want to present an image of firmness and strength Harshness in the direct approach.

Using the indirect approach

Beginning a disappointing news message with a blunt "no" could well prevent people who prefer an explanation first from reading or listening to your reasons. Presenting the reasons first increases your chances of gaining audience acceptance by gradually preparing readers for the negative news to come.

The indirect approach follows a four-part sequence:

1. Open with a buffer
2. Continue with a logical, neutral explanation of the reasons for the disappointing-news
3. Follow with a clear but diplomatic statement of the disappointing-news (emphasizing any good news and de-emphasizing the bad), and
4. Close with a positive, forward-looking statement that is helpful and friendly.

Tact and courtesy in an indirect refusal

The example below skillfully handles the negative message. Its opening words are on subject and neutral. They set up the explanation that follows. The clear and logical explanation ties in with the opening. Using no negative words, the explanation leads smoothly to the refusal.

Begin with a Buffer

The first step in using the indirect approach is to make a neutral, no controversial statement that is closely related to the point of the message; this statement is called a buffer.

A good buffer expresses your appreciation for being thought of, assures the reader of your attention to the request, compliments the reader, or indicates your understanding of the reader's needs.

Use a buffer that is:

- Neutral
- Relevant
- Not misleading
- Self-confident
- Brief

Here are some things to avoid when writing a buffer:

- **Avoid saying no:-**

An audience encountering the blunt refusal right at the beginning usually reacts negatively to the rest of the message, no matter how reasonable and well phrased it is.

- **Avoid using a know-it-all tone:-**

When you use phrases such as “you should be aware that,” “readers expect your lecture to lead to a negative response, so they resist the rest of your message.

- **Avoid wordy and irrelevant phrases and sentences:-**

Sentences such as “We have received your letter,” “This letter is in reply to your request,” and “We are writing in response to your request” are irrelevant. Make better use of the space by referring directly to the subject of the letter.

- **Avoid apologizing:-**

Unless warranted by extreme circumstances, an apology only weakens the explanation of your unfavorable news that follows.

- **Avoid writing a buffer that is too long:-**

Be brief. Identify something that both you and your audience are interested in and agree on before proceeding in a businesslike way.

Types of Buffer

Buffer	Strategy	Example
Agreement	Find a point on which you and the reader share similar views	We both know how hard it is to make a profit in this industry
Appreciation	Express sincere thanks for Something	Your cheque for PRs. 5.000 arrived receiving yesterday. Thank you
Cooperation	Convey your willingness to help you realistically can	Employee services are here to smooth in any way the way for all of you who work to achieve company's goals.
Fairness	Assure the reader that you have closely examined and carefully monitored those using the photocopy considered the problem, or machine to see whether we can mention an appropriate action that detect any pattern of use that might has already been taken	For the past week, we have carefully explain its frequent breakdowns
Praise	Find an attribute or an achievement to compliment.	Your resume shows an admirable breadth of experience which should serve you well as you progress in your career.
Understanding	Demonstrate that you understand the reader's goals and needs.	So that you can more easily find the printer with the features you need, we are enclosing a brochure that describes all the XYZ printers currently available.
Good news	- Start with the part of your message that is favorable	A replacement knob for your range is . on its way, shipped Sept. 2005

Lesson 38 Disappointing-News Letters

Follow with reasons Well-written reasons are:

- Detailed:**
Provide enough detail to make the reason for the refusal logically acceptable.
- Tactful:**
Implies that the applicant is better off avoiding a program in which he or she would probably fail, given the background of potential co-workers.
- Individualized:**
Explains the company's policy as logical rather than rigid
- Unapologetic:**

Offers no apology for the decision

5. **Positive:**

Avoids negative personal expressions like “You do not meet our requirements”

State the refusal

Three techniques are useful for saying no as clearly and as kindly as possible:

Firstly, de-emphasize the disappointing-news:

- Minimize the space or time devoted to the disappointing-news.
- Subordinate disappointing-news in a complex or compound sentence
- Embed disappointing-news in the middle of a paragraph or use parenthetical

Second, use a conditional (if or when) statement to imply that the audience could have received, or might someday receive, a favorable answer:

(“When you have more managerial experience, you are welcome to reapply”). Such a statement could motivate applicants to improve their qualifications.

Third, tell the audience what you did, can do, or will do, rather than what you did not do, cannot do, or will not do:

By focusing on the positive and implying the disappointing-news, you soften the blow.

Close with goodwill

After giving your audience the disappointing-news, your job is to end your message on an upbeat note. Follow these guidelines:

- Keep it positive
- Limit future correspondence – Encourage additional communication only if you are willing to discuss your decision further (avoid wording such as: “If you have further questions, please write”).
- Be optimistic about the future – Don’t anticipate problems (avoid statements such as: “Should you have further problems, please let us know”).
- Be sincere – Steer clear of clichés that are insincere in view of the disappointing-news (avoid saying: “If we can be of any help, please contact us”).
- Be confident – Don’t show any doubt about keeping the person as a customer (avoid phrases such as: “We hope you will continue to do business with us”).

Refusing request for information

When people ask you for information and you can’t honor the request, you may answer with either the direct approach or the indirect approach. Say that you’ve asked a company to

participate in your research project concerning sales promotion. However, that company has a policy against disseminating any information about projected sales figures.

Lesson 39 Disappointing-News Letters

Refusing request for a favour

When you must say no to a requested favor, your use of the direct or indirect approach depends on your relationship with the reader. For example, the principal of a local college asks your company to host graduation on your corporate grounds, but your sales meetings will be taking place at the same time. If you do not know the principal, you will use the indirect approach. If you are friends you'll probably use the direct approach.

Refusing a refund

An out-of-town customer bought an expensive dress and mailed it back three weeks later, asking for a refund. The customer explained that the dress was not a good fit and that she really did not like it anymore. But perspiration stains on the dress proved that she had worn it.

Refusing a claim

Almost every customer who makes a claim is emotionally involved; therefore, the indirect method is usually the best approach for a refusal. When refusing a claim, avoid language that might have a negative impact on the reader. Instead, demonstrate that you understand and have considered the complaint. The, even if the claim is unreasonable, rationally explain why you are refusing request. Remember, don't apologize and don't rely on company policy. End the letter on a respectful and action-oriented note.

Declining an invitation

From time to time, invitations must be declined. The reasons necessitating regrets are varied, ranging from a potential conflict of interest to a lack of time. Regardless of the reason for the refusal, the letter of decline must be tactful and courteous. The letter declining an invitation below is much more likely to produce a better relationship between the writer and the reader.

Rejecting job applications

It's difficult to tactfully tell job applicants that you won't be offering them employment. But don't let the difficulty stop you from communicating the disappointing-news. Follow 3-guidelines:

- Open with the direct approach:-

If you buffer, you appear manipulative, because you otherwise phone.

- Clearly state why the applicant was not selected:-

Make your rejection less personal by stating that you hired someone more experienced, whose qualifications match the position requirements more closely.

- Close by suggesting alternatives:-

Mention other openings within the company. Application will be considered for future openings.

Do's & Don'ts to follow in preparing disappointing-news messages Suggestions of a Do-Nature

Suggestions for enhancing the effectiveness of disappointing-news messages are presented below. Each suggestion is followed by one or more sentences that illustrate its use.

1. **Use a neutral or buffered opening that produces agreement:-**
rather than disagreement. When you purchase a Green Products lawn mower, you have every right to expect that it will be of the quality commonly associated with the Green Products. The items you recently ordered from us have been selling very well.
2. **Discuss the facts and analyze the situation in sufficient detail:-**
which will help convince the reader of your honesty and sincerity. We consider a number of factors when reviewing applications for credit. Included are such factors as length of time at one residence, length of time of current employment, income, assets, bill-paying record, and amount of current financial obligations.
3. **Consider using an implicit refusal rather than an explicit refusal:-**
The warranty that came with your Mix-Rice electric mixer is in effect for the first year of ownership, beginning with the date of purchase. Our records show your mixer was purchased more than two years ago.
4. **Capitalize on what you can do for the reader rather than what you cannot do:-**
We are offering you a 2% discount on all cash purchases for the next six months. During the second year of ownership of your XY Computer, our warranty covers the cost of labor when making repairs if you purchase the parts from us. We are currently offering a 5% discount on the list price of all XY parts.
5. **Use sales-promotion material whenever appropriate**
You will be glad to know that we just received authorization to distribute the Pak sportswear line. To help introduce this new line to our customers, we are offering a 3% introductory discount on all Pak merchandise ordered on or before Dec. 1.
6. **Offer suggestions to prevent a recurrence of the problem situation:-**
To keep your Green-Products lawn mower operating at peak performance in the future, we suggest that you use only Green-Products oil-gas mixture.
7. **Make a counteroffer or counter-proposal, if appropriate:-**
We believe it will be in your immediate best interest for us to set your credit limit at Rs. 75,000 rather than the 1,00,000 you requested.
8. **Make reader action easy, if appropriate:-**
If you would like us to substitute "Fancy Shirtings" in the same quantity and size for the out-of-stock "Brand-Shirtings" that you ordered, please call me on 586..... The Brand shirting's can be shipped as soon as we hear from you.

Suggestions of a Don't-Nature

1. **Avoid the use of negative words or phrases.**

We regret that we cannot exchange your recently purchased S-radio for SR-radio, as you requested.

2. **Avoid the use of harsh tone.**

Your new power cutter malfunctioned because you failed to assemble it properly.

3. **Avoid placing the statement of refusal in a position of emphasis.**

For the reasons outlined in the above paragraph, we are sure you will understand why we cannot honor your request for a full refund on the formal dress you recently purchased from us.

4. **Avoid using company policy as the reason for justifying the refusal.**

Our company has a policy that prohibits the use of our facilities for anything other than official company business.

5. **Avoid making ideas that are not likely to occur.**

Now that you have heard our side of the story, we are certain that you will agree with our decision.

6. **Avoid apologizing for the action you are taking.**

We are sorry that we cannot grant your request.

7. **Avoid a slow-start opening.**

We have received your letter of Jan.

8. **Avoid a meaningless closing.**

Thanks for getting in touch with us.

9. **Avoid suggesting that problems may arise again in the future.**

Should you feel, after we repair and return your VCR, that it is not giving you the quality of service that you have the right to expect, please contact.

10. **Avoid phony or insincere empathy.**

We know just how upset you were when the heating coil in your coffee maker burned out in the middle of your dinner party.

Lesson 40 Writing Persuasive Message

Planning Persuasive Message

Unlike routine positive messages, persuasive messages aim to influence audiences who are inclined to resist. Therefore, persuasive messages are generally longer, are usually more detailed, and often depend heavily on strategic planning. Persuasive messages require that you pay particular attention to several planning tasks. E.g. because your purpose is to persuade, making sure of your purpose is perhaps the most important planning task. When analyzing your audience for a persuasive message, you may want to delve more deeply than you would for other messages. Your credibility takes on extra importance in a persuasive message. So whenever you are trying to persuade someone, you must make sure your ethics are above reproach.

Analyze your purpose

Writing an external persuasive message is one of the most difficult tasks you could undertake. For one thing, your purpose is to persuade people to do something different or to try something new. But people are busy, so they are reluctant to act, especially if it takes time and offers no guarantee of any

reward in return. Given the complexity and sensitivity of persuasive messages, you must be absolutely sure that your purpose is clear, necessary, and appropriate for written media.

Analyze your audience

Process of audience analysis is much more involved for persuasive messages. To write an effective persuasive argument, you need to search for common ground, points of agreement on which to build. That means you must shape your argument so that others believe your proposal will satisfy their concerns and bring them rewards.

Gauging audience needs

Consider these important questions: Who is my audience? What are their needs? What do I want to do? How might they resist? Are there alternative positions I need to examine? What does the decision maker consider the most important issue? How might the organization's culture influence my strategy?

Considering cultural differences

Your understanding and respect for cultural differences will help you satisfy the needs of your audience and will help your audience respect you. That's because persuasion is different in different cultures. In France, using aggressive, hard sell techniques is no way to win respect. In Germany, people tend to focus on technical details, verify any figures you use for support, and make sure they are exact. In Sweden, people focus on theoretical questions and strategic implications. In the US people are concerned with more practical matters.

Establish your credibility

To persuade a skeptical or hostile audience, you must convince people that you know what you are talking about and that you are not trying to mislead them. Your credibility is your capability of being believed because you are reliable and worthy of confidence.

Some of the ways to gain credibility are:

- **Name your sources:**-Telling your audience where your information comes from and who agrees with you always improves your credibility, especially if your sources are already respected by your audience.
- **Be an expert:**-Your knowledge of your message's subject area (or even of some other area) helps you give your audience the quality information necessary to make a decision.
- **Establish common ground:**- Those beliefs, attitudes, and background experiences that you have in common with members of your audience will help them identify with you. Be enthusiastic. Your excitement about your subject can infect your audience.
- **Be objective:** - Your ability to understand and acknowledge all sides of an issue helps you present fair and logical argument in your persuasive message.
- **Be sincere:** - Your concern, genuineness, good faith, and truthfulness help you focus on your audience's needs.
- **Be trustworthy:** - Your honesty and dependability help you earn your audience's respect.
- **Have good intentions:**-Your willingness to keep your audience's best interests at heart helps you create persuasive messages that are ethical. Your credibility will also be enhanced if you maintain high ethical standards.

Strive for high ethical standards

Persuasion is wrongly associated with coaxing, urging, and sometimes even tricking people into accepting an idea, buying a product, or taking an unwanted or unneeded action. However, the best businesspeople make persuasion positive. They influence audience members by providing information and aiding understanding, which allows audiences the freedom to choose. Ethical businesspeople inform audiences of the benefits of an idea, an organization, a product, a donation, or an action so that these audiences can recognize just how well the idea, organization, product, donation, or action will satisfy a need they truly have.

Developing Persuasive Messages

- Your success as a businessperson is closely tied to your ability to convince others to accept or act on your recommendations. Minimally, you want them to pay close attention to your ideas and value your contributions.
- Some formal strategies you can use to strengthen your persuasive skills.

Strategies for Persuasive Messages

Effective persuasion involves four distinct and essential strategies:

1. Framing your arguments
2. Balancing emotional and logical appeals
3. Reinforcing your position
4. Dealing with resistance

1. Framing your arguments

To effectively persuade your audience, you need to frame your argument in the most effective way. Most persuasive messages follow an organizational plan that goes beyond the indirect approach used for negative messages. The opening does more than serve as a buffer; it grabs your audience's attention. The explanation section does more than present reasons, and it is expanded to two sections. The first incites audience's interest, and the second changes your audience's attitude. Finally, your close does more than end on a positive note with a statement of what action is needed; it emphasizes reader benefits and motivates readers to take specific action. Organizing persuasive messages plan involves four phases:

a. Attention

Begin the message with an attention-getting statement that is:

- Personalized
- you-oriented
- straightforward
- relevant

Make your audience want to hear about your problem or idea. Write a brief engaging opening sentence, with no extravagant claims or irrelevant points. And be sure to find some common ground on which to build your case.

b. Interest

In the interest section

- continue the opening theme in great detail
- relate benefits specifically to the attention-getter

Explain the relevance of your message to your audience. Continuing the theme you started with, point a more detailed picture with words. Gets your audience thinking?

c. Desire

In the interest section

- provide evidence to prove your claim
- draw attention to any enclosures

Make audience members want to change by explaining how the change will benefit them. Reduce resistance by thinking up and answering in advance any questions the audience might have. If your idea is complex, explain how you would implement it. Back up your claims in order to increase audience willingness to take the action that you suggest in the next section. Just remember to make sure that all evidence is directly relevant to your point.

d. Action

End by

- suggesting a specific step the audience can take
- restating how the audience will benefit by acting as you wish
- making action clear and easy

Suggest the action you want readers to take. Make it more than a statement such as “Please institute this program soon” or “send me a refund”. This is the opportunity to remind readers of the benefits of taking action. The secret of a successful action phase is making the action easy.

2. Balancing emotional and logical appeals

How do you actually convince an audience that your position is the right one, that your plan will work or that your company will do the most with reader’s donation? One way is to appeal to the audience’s minds and hearts. Together, these two elements have a good chance of persuading your audience to act.

Finding the right balance between the two types of appeals depends on four factors:

- i. The actions you wish to motivate
- ii. Your reader’s expectations,
- iii. The degree of resistance you must overcome,
- iv. How far you feel empowered to go in selling your point of view

Emotional Appeals:

An emotional appeal calls on human feelings, basing the argument on audience needs or sympathies; however, such an appeal must be subtle. For example, you can make use of the emotion surrounding certain words. The word freedom evokes strong feelings, as do words such as success, prestige, credit record, savings, free, value, and comfort. Such words put your audience in a certain frame of mind and

help them accept your message. However, emotional appeals aren't necessarily effective by themselves. Emotion works with logic in a unique way. People need to find rational support for an attitude they're already embraced emotionally.

Logical Appeals:

A logical appeal calls on human reason. In any argument you might use to persuade an audience, you make a claim and then support your claim with reasons or evidence. When appealing to your audience's logic, you might use three types of reasoning:

- **Analogy** With analogy, you reason from specific evidence to specific evidence. For instance, to persuade employees to attend a planning session, you might use a town meeting analogy, comparing your company to a small community and your employees to valued members of that community.
- **Induction** With induction, you reason from specific evidence to general conclusion. To convince potential customers that your product is best, you might report the results of test marketing in which individuals preferred your product over others. After all, if some individuals prefer it, so will others.
- **Deduction** With deduction, you might reason from a generalization to a specific conclusion. To persuade your boss to hire additional employees, you might point to industry-wide projections and explain that industry activity (and thus your company's business) will be increasing rapidly over the next three months, so you'll need more employees to handle increased business.

Lesson 41 Writing Persuasive Message

Writing Persuasive Message

No matter what reasoning method you use, any argument or statement can easily appear to be true when it's actually false. Whenever you appeal to your audience's reason do everything you can to strengthen your argument by finding common ground (basing your major argument on points that your audience already accepts) and by stating your points clearly. Finally, keep your arguments relevant, well grounded, and systematic. To avoid faulty logic, practice the following guidelines:

- **Avoid hasty generalizations:** Make sure you have plenty of evidence before drawing conclusions.
- **Avoid begging the question:** Make sure you can support your claim without simply restating it in different words.
- **Avoid attacking your opponent.** Be careful to address the real question. Attack the argument your opponent is making, not your opponent's character.
- **Avoid oversimplifying a complex issue.** Make sure you present all the factors rather than relying on an "either/or" statement that makes it look as if only two choices are possible.

- **Avoid assuming a false cause.** Use cause-and-effect reasoning correctly; do not assume that one event caused another just because it happened first.
- **Avoid faulty analogies.** Be sure that the two objects or situations being compared are similar enough for the analogy to hold. Even if A resembles B in one respect, it may not hold true in other important respects.
- **Avoid illogical support.** Make sure the connection between your claims and your support is truly logical and not based on a leap of faith, a missing premise, or irrelevant evidence.

Reinforcing your position

Once you have framed your arguments and chosen your appeal, you can concentrate on strengthening your message with some important persuasive tools. Effective persuaders know that the facts alone may not be enough to persuade your audience. So they supplement numerical data with examples, stories, metaphors, and analogies to make their position come alive.

Instead of this Say this

1. I think we should attempt to get let's get immediate approval on this. Approval on this before it's too late.
2. This plan could work if we really with our support, this plan will work. Push it.
3. I have been thinking lately that After careful thought over the past two may be someone could ... months, I have decided that

Other Tools

Using semantics skillfully is not your only persuasive tools. Here are some additional techniques you can use to strengthen your persuasive messages:

- **Be moderate.** Asking your audience to make major changes in attitudes or beliefs will most likely evoke a negative response. However, asking audience members to take one step toward that change may be a more reasonable goal.
- **Focus on your goal.** Your message will be clearest if you shift your focus away from changing minds and emphasize the action you want your audience to take.
- **Use simple language.** In most persuasive situations, your audience will be cautious, watching for fantastic claims, insupportable descriptions, and emotional manipulation. So speak plainly and simply.
- **Anticipate opposition.** Think of every possible objection in advance. In your message, you might raise and answer some of these counterarguments.
- **Provide sufficient support.** It is up to you to prove that the change you seek is necessary.
- **Be specific.** Back up your claims with evidence, and when necessary cite actual facts and figures. Let your audience know that you have done your homework.

- **Create a win-win situation.** Make it possible for both you and your audience to gain something. Audience members will find it easier to deal with change if they stand to benefit.
- **Time your message appropriately.** The time to sell roofs is right after the tornado. - Timing is crucial in persuasive messages.
- **Speak metaphorically.** Metaphors create powerful pictures. One metaphor can convey a lifetime of experience or a head full of logic.
- **Use anecdotes and stories to make your points.** Anecdotes tie it all together – the logic and the emotions. Don't tell your audience what kinds of problems they can have if their system clashes. Tell them what happened to Mr. X when his hard drive crashed in the middle of his annual sales presentation.

Dealing with resistance

The best way to deal with audience resistance is to eliminate it. If you expect a hostile audience, one biased against your plan from the beginning, present all sides – cover all options, explaining the pros and cons of each. You will gain additional credibility if you present these options before presenting the decision.

When putting together persuasive arguments, avoid common mistakes such as:

Using an up-front hard sell:

Setting out a strong position at the start of a persuasive message gives potential opponents something to grab onto and fight against.

Resisting compromise:

Persuasion is a process of give and take. As one expert point out, a persuader rarely changes another person's behavior or viewpoint without altering his or her own in the process.

Relying solely on great arguments:

In persuading people arguments matter, but they are only one part of the equation. Your ability to create a mutually beneficial framework for your position, to connect with your audience on the right emotional level, and to communicate through vivid language are all just as important; they bring your argument to life.

Lesson 42 Writing Persuasive Message

The Sales Letters

The suggested plan for a sales letter includes the following elements:

1. An opening that attracts the reader's attention.
2. A section that captures the reader's interest in the product or service you are selling;
3. A section designed to establish desire and conviction on the part of the reader;
4. A courteous, action-oriented closing.

Collection Letters

Collection letters are also considered persuasive because the inclusion of motivationally oriented material is designed to get the reader to comply with your request. Because the reader may not be readily able nor willing to comply with your request, you have to take extra measures to assure compliance.

Use of one or more appeals in writing effective letters is discussed below:

Appeal to fair play

The fair-play appeal essentially says to the customer: "We have been fair with you by providing the quality of product and services that you have the right to receive, and now you need to be fair with us by paying your account in full."

Appeal to pride

Another appeal commonly used in collection letters is to pride, which involves asking the reader to act in ways that he/she can be proud of in this case, paying the past-due account. During the six years that you have had a charge account with us, we have been very proud of the way in which you have met your financial obligations. We are sure that you, too, take a great pride in keeping your account balance paid up.

Appeal to fear legal action

When all other appeals have failed to entice the customer to pay, the company may include a statement of intended action in the final collection letter. We believe that we have given you ample time to pay your account or at least to explain to us why you have chosen not to pay. Now we are forced to take more drastic action.

Memoranda and Short Reports

What is a Memo?

A memorandum, also called as a memo, is a message written to use within the organization. Traditionally letters are used for external communication; ordinarily the memo is intended solely for communicating with others within the organization.

General Format

The format is fairly standard. If printed memo forms are not available, the following headings can be typed on a sheet of paper:

- To:
- From:
- Date:

- Subject:

Basic Purpose

Memos are prepared for:

- Requesting information
- Giving instructions
- Serving as covers for all messages, and
- Making announcements

Advantages of a Memo:

- Solves problems (by transmitting information)
 - By informing reader about solutions e.g.,
 - Policy Changes
 - Price Increases
 - By persuading reader to take actions e.g.,
- Attend a Meeting
- Change Current Production Procedure
- Provides a written record
- Can reach many persons simultaneously

A Memo requesting information

The following suggestions will be helpful in writing a memo requesting information:

- State the key idea, the request.
- Present the details.
- Remind the reader of the request and provide additional specific information.

A transmittal Memo

A transmittal memo is used to introduce the reader to a longer, accompanying message. Besides the introduction it describes the main points of the message.

An announcement Memo

Memos may be used to announce such matters as personnel transfers, meetings, or policy changes.

Memorandum Reports

- Progress reports
- Periodic reports
- Justification reports
- Letter reports

Progress reports

The content of a progress report is determined by the familiarity of the report reader with the project. The suggested plan for a progress report includes the following elements:

- Introduction
- Summary of progress already reported
- Detailed summary of progress since last reporting
- Nature of exceptional progress
- Summary of work yet to be completed

Justification Report

Sometime you have to write a memorandum report in order to justify something a change in procedure, an increase in budget, or perhaps reasons for resisting any new policy. For whatever reason and there are many it is written, the justification report is a common type of memorandum report.

The justification report follows a direct or deductive plan, which means that the recommendations and conclusions are presented before the facts and findings. This plan is used because the most important section of justification reports typically is the recommendation.

Letter reports

- Basic difference is their destination
- Are useful for presenting limited amount of information (1 to 4 pages & use a regular letter format)

Lesson 43 Writing Résumés

What is a Résumé?

A résumé is a one or two page summary of your skills, accomplishments, experiences, and education designed to capture a prospective employer's interest. The purpose of a résumé is to create interest and secure an interview. It is the primary tool of your job search and may take several drafts to prepare effectively.

Fallacies and facts about Résumé

Fallacy	Fact
The purpose of a résumé is to list all your skills & abilities.	The purpose of a résumé is to kindle employer interest & generate an interview
A good résumé will get you the door.	All a résumé can do is getting you in job you want.
Your résumé will be read carefully And thoroughly by an interested employer.	Your résumé probably has less than 45 seconds to make an impression.
The more good information you present about yourself in your résumé, the better.	Too much info on a résumé may actually kill the reader's appetite to know more.
If you want a really good résumé, have it prepared by a résumé service.	Prepare your own résumé unless the position is especially high-level or specialized. Even then, you should check carefully before using a service.

Adapt your résumé to your audience

Because your résumé will have little time to make an impression, be sure to adopt a “you” attitude and think about your résumé from the employer’s perspective. Ask yourself:

1. What key qualifications will this employer are looking for?
2. Which of these qualifications are your greatest strengths?
3. What quality would set you apart from other candidates in the eyes of a potential employer?
4. What are three or four of your greatest accomplishments, and what resulted from these accomplishments?

Writing your résumé

To write a successful résumé you need to convey seven qualities that employers seek. You want to show that you:

1. think in terms of results,
2. know how to get things done,
3. are well rounded,
4. show signs of progress,
5. have personal standards of excellence,
6. are flexible and willing to try new things, and
7. Possess strong communication skills.

As you organize and compose your résumé, think about how you can convey those seven qualities.

What do you have to offer?

Get started by jotting down 10 achievements you are proud of, such as taking a prize-winning photo, tutoring a child, or editing your college magazine. Think carefully about what specific skills these achievements demanded. For example, leadership skills, speaking ability, and artistic talent may have helped you coordinate a winning presentation. As you analyze your achievements, you will begin to recognize a pattern of skills. Which of them might be valuable to potential employers?

What do you want to do? Not important butt read must

What you can do is one thing. What you want to do is another. Discover the things that will bring satisfaction and happiness on the job.

1. How would you like to work? Consider how much independence you want on the job, how much variety you like, and whether you prefer to work with machines, ideas, people, figures, or some combination thereof. Do you like physical work, mental work, or a mix? Constant change or a predictable role?
2. What specific compensation do you expect? What do you hope to earn in your first year? What kind of pay increase do you expect each year? What's your ultimate earnings goal? Would you be comfortable getting paid on commission, or do you prefer a steady paycheck? Are you willing to settle for less money in order to do something you really love?
3. Can you establish some personal career goals? Consider where you'd like to start, where you'd like to go from there, and the ultimate position you'd like to attain. How soon after joining the company would you like to receive your first promotion? Your next one? What additional training or preparation will you need to achieve them?
4. What size company would you prefer? Do you like the idea of working for a small, entrepreneurial operation? Or would you prefer a large corporation?
5. What type of operation is appealing to you? Would you prefer to work a profit-making company or a non-profit organization? Are you attracted to service business or manufacturing operations? Do you want regular, predictable hours, or do you thrive on flexible, varied hours? Would you enjoy a seasonally varied job such as education (which may give you summer off) or retailing (with its selling cycles)?
6. What locations would you like? Would you like to work in a city, a suburb, a small town, an industrial area, or an uptown setting? Do you like working indoors or outdoors?
7. What facilities do you envision? Is it important to you to work in an attractive place, or will simple, functional quarters sufficed? Do you need a quiet office to work effectively, or can you concentrate in a noisy, open setting? Is access to public transportation or freeways important?
8. What sort of corporate culture are you comfortable with? Would you be happy in a formal hierarchy with clear reporting relationships? Or do you prefer less structure? Are you looking for a paternalistic firm or one that fosters individualism? Do you like a competitive environment? One that rewards teamwork? What qualities do you want in a boss?

The well written résumé may include a persuasively arranged summary of:

- Name & address
- Career objective or summary of qualifications
- Education and training
- Work experience, skills, and accomplishments
- Activities and achievements
- Personal Data (memberships, honor and awards, hobbies and interests.)
- References

Name & address

This constitutes the heading of the résumé. It includes the applicant's name, address, telephone number(s), e-mail address.

Career objective or summary of qualifications

This section must be prepared with as much clarity of thought and specificity as possible. Remember, your goal is to generate interest immediately. If you decide to state your objective, make it effective by being as specific as possible about what you want.

Education and training

List the latest educational or training level first and work chronologically backward from there. Account for any significant gaps between major educational training events. Include your degree or diploma, major field, institution, and date of attainment for each level.

Work experience, skills, and accomplishments

Tailor your description to highlight the relationship between your previous responsibilities and your target field. When describing your work experience, list your jobs in chronological orders, with the current or last one first. However the reverse chronological order is preferred. Include any part-time, summer, or intern positions, even if unrelated to your current career objective.

Activities and achievements

Your résumé should also describe any volunteer activities that demonstrate your abilities. List projects that require leadership, organization, teamwork, and cooperation. Emphasize career-related activities such as "member of the Student Marketing Association." List skills you learned in these activities, and explain how these skills are related to the job you are applying for.

Personal data

Provide additional information about yourself, if not mentioned earlier

References

When listing the names, titles, addresses, and telephone numbers of references, obtain their permission prior to submitting the resume. Choose those people who represent the range of various facets of your career and professional talents and experiences.

The chronological résumé

The work-experience section dominates and is placed in the most prominent slot, immediately after the name and address and the objective. You develop this section by listing your jobs sequentially in reverse order, beginning with the most recent position and working backward toward earlier jobs.

1. Employees are familiar with it and can easily find information.
2. It highlights growth and career progression, and
3. It highlights employment continuity and stability

Lesson #44 Writing Résumés

The functional résumé

A functional resume emphasizes a list of skills and accomplishments, identifying employers and academic experience in subordinate sections.

This approach has three advantages:

- Without having to read through job descriptions, employers can see what you can do for them,
- You can emphasize earlier job experience, and
- You can de-emphasize any lack of career progress or lengthy unemployment.

Objective
To work as director of marketing.
Relevant Skills
• Training and Development
2 years of experience as the training and development manager for A & R Co.
• Organization Development
2 years of experience as an organization development planner for D. B. Consultants
• Managing
Trained part-time employees of B. Services in cash register operation and customer services.
Work Experience
Manager, Training and Development, A & R Co., March 1, 2003 to April 15, 2005
Organization Development Planner, D. B. Consultants, Jan. 30, 2001 to Feb. 28, 2003
Education
Master of Business Administration (3.8 GPA/4.0 scale). V. University, Aug. 2000

These suggestions aid in completing application forms:

1. Keep your résumé up to date, and carry a copy of it with you.
2. Read the instructions on the form carefully before beginning to complete it.
3. If the instructions specify printing or handwriting responses, do as required.
4. Complete every blank on the form – even if you have to insert entries like “None,” “Not applicable.”
5. Complete the form correctly and neatly. Carry a small dictionary with you to spell words correctly.
6. For open-end questions, organize your thoughts carefully and write a draft of the answer on a piece of paper before transferring to the form.
7. Answer questions honestly, but in a manner that will emphasize strengths, not weaknesses.
8. As suggested for the résumé, consider carefully whether to include or omit answers to questions that you may not legally have to answer.
9. If the form includes a question about what salary you expect to receive, write an actual figure or range of figures if you have made such a decision, or write something like this:
 - The typical salary paid for the position to someone of my ability
 - To be discussed during interview
 - Negotiable
 - Open for discussion.
10. Upon completion, review the entries for completeness and accuracy.

Interviewing

Getting Ready

1. Review your resume.
2. Try to find out information about the interviewer.
3. Formulate answers to questions you are likely to be asked.
4. Become familiar with nonverbal cues that can enhance your interview performance.

Thinking ahead about questions

Planning ahead for the questions will help handle them more confidently and intelligently:

- Tell us something about yourself.
- What are your greater strengths?
- What are your greater weaknesses?
- Why is your GPA not higher?
- Why do you want to work for this organization?
- If we hire you, what changes would you make?
- What didn't you like about previous jobs you have had?

- Where do you want to be five years from now?
- What are your salary expectations?
- Is money important to you?

Making a good impression during the interview

1. Appropriate dress is important for a good first impression.
2. Be on time.
3. Be confident and courteous.
4. Keep eye contact with the interviewer.
5. Provide thoughtful, direct, & honest answers.
6. Avoid asking questions about salary

What do interviewers evaluate?

1. How mentally alert and responsive is the applicant?
2. Is the applicant able to draw proper inferences and conclusions?
3. Does the applicant demonstrate a degree of intellectual depth when communicating or is his/her ability shallow and lacking in depth?
4. What is the applicant's capacity for problem solving?
5. How well does the applicant respond to stress and pressure?
6. Can the applicant succeed in the position for which he/she is being interviewed?
7. Can the applicant be trusted?
8. Is the applicant professionally and socially mature?

The most Critical Success Factors employers are looking for:

1. Positive attitude toward work
2. Proficiency in field of study
3. Communication skills (written & oral)
4. Interpersonal skills
5. Confidence
6. Critical thinking and problem-solving skills
7. Flexibility
8. Self-motivation
9. Leadership
10. Teamwork
11. Leadership

People with high EQ

Research shows that employees with certain personality traits tend to be more successful at their job. As a result, many employers today seek candidates with a high “emotional intelligence,” or EQ (emotional quotient). People with a high EQ generally possess these desirable attributes: self-awareness, good impulse control, persistence, confidence, self-

motivation, and empathy, as well as the abilities to persuade, articulate a mission, interpret the mood of a group, and communicate with people in terms they understand.

People with high EQ:

- Think clearly and stay focused on the task at hand while under pressure.
- Admit to their mistakes.
- Meet commitments and keep promises.
- Hold themselves accountable for meeting their goals.
- Seek new ideas from a variety of sources.
- Handle multiple demands and changing priorities.
- Make sacrifices to meet an important organizational goal.
- Cut through red tape and bend outdated rules when necessary.
- Seek fresh perspectives, even if that means trying something totally new.
- Operate from an expectation of success rather than a fear of failure.
- Try to learn how to improve their performance.
- Set challenging goals and take calculated risks to reach them.

Lesson #45 Oral and Written Communication techniques

Which delved on knowing about “**self concept**” and “**self image**”, and ending on the note of having a “**self-assessment**” made before drawing your future roadmap (or writing your resume for the job search).

1. Becoming a **smart thinker**;
2. Being an active **listener**; and
3. Becoming an effective **speaker**.

1. Think smartly

The ability to **define** and **solve problems** by finding and **applying relevant** knowledge. Ways to present and process information effectively.

A lack of identity often results in a lack of direction. You must know your strengths and weaknesses; otherwise the process of defining your goals and working toward them would be flawed. So, start thinking now. Thinking seriously and smartly.

2. Listen actively

Interact with people, listening, speaking, reading, and writing, **nearly 42% of our waking time** is spent in listening. A good communicator needs to be a good listener; otherwise barriers occur and affectivity suffers.

3. Speak effectively

Speak clearly, maintain an even tone, and make eye contact. Keep your body language relaxed and open. Wrap up with a summary and then stop. Summarize your response and then stop talking, even if it leaves a silence in the room.

Salient components of an effective speech are the:

- Speaker
- Message
- Audience
- Channel
- Feedback
- Setting

❖ **The speaker**

(It begins the moment you address the audience.)

- a. Speaker's motivation
- b. Speaker's credibility
- c. Speaker's delivery or the speaker's style

➤ Speaker's motivation

It can be approached in terms of two considerations:

- direct personal reward (monetary compensation)
- Indirect rewards (feeling good about helping others) are involved.

➤ Speaker's credibility:

A speaker's ideas are accepted as believable only to the degree that the speaker is perceived to be credible. The speaker's credibility depends on his/her trustworthiness, competence, and good will.

➤ Speaker's motivation:

The delivery, the way the message is presented, should complement the speech's objective. A well-written speech delivered poorly can quickly lose effectiveness.

❖ **The message**

The message refers to everything a speaker does or says, both verbally and non-verbally. The verbal component may be analyzed in terms of three basic elements:

- a. Content
- b. Style
- c. Structure

b. **Contents**

what you say about your topic

- MEAT of your speech or presentation.
- Research your topic thoroughly.
- Decide on how much to say about each subject.

c. **Style**

The content of your speech is your style. Styles can vary from very formal to the very informal.

d. **Structure**

The structure of a message is its organization. There are many organizational variations, but in each case, the structure should include:

- i. **An Introduction**
- ii. **A Body**
- iii. **A Conclusion**

- **An Introduction**

- An opening grabber such as a quote or shocking statistic.
- an agenda
- The purpose or main message of your presentation.

- **A Body**

- Your main points or ideas.
- Points which support your main message.

- **A Conclusion**

- a summary of your main points.
- a closing grabber.
- time for questions & answers, if appropriate

❖ **The audience**

As a speaker you should analyze your listeners and then decide how to present your ideas. This analysis might include considerations related to: age, sex, marital status, race, geographic location, group membership, education, career etc.

❖ **The channel**

When we communicate with our audiences, we use many channels of communication. This includes **nonverbal, pictorial and aural channels**. It is very important that you use as many channels as you can to communicate with your audience.

B. Nonverbal

1. gestures
2. facial expressions
3. body movement

4. posture

C. Pictorial

1. diagrams
2. charts
3. graphs
4. pictures
5. objects

D. Aural

1. tone of your voice
2. variations in pitch and volume
3. other vocal variety

❖ The feedback

By "**feedback**" the speaker receives information **about how his or her** message has been received by the **listeners and, in turn, responds to those cues**. The feedback process **is not complete** until the speaker has **responded to the listener**. This process includes the **listener's** reactions to the speaker's **response and so forth**.

❖ The setting

The place in which you **deliver your presentation** may be one that **enhances or interferes with the effectiveness** of your presentation. Determine ahead of time what the facilities are like before you speak. This way you can properly plan your delivery or make adjustments, if necessary.

Write purposefully

Good writing style is important to **good communication**. Communication happens only when you write something that somebody else reads and understands. For this, you must **use words and concepts** that mean the **same thing to you and to your reader**.

Planning and organizing, before you start writing purposefully. Refer back to the exercise of going through the following four steps:

- Determining your purpose
- Considering your reader
- Choosing your idea
- Determining your content

Much of your **writing success** could be attributed to **the quality of preparation**, which could consume as much as 60% of the total time devoted to the actual writing.

Live happily

Communication performs many important functions related to our day-to-day needs. Our **success in satisfying our personal needs rests** with **our skills in interpreting** and responding to the communication behavior of other people

- We need more communication,
- Communication eliminates problems, and
- Meanings are in words.